

من عاش بعد الموت
**Those Who Lived
After Death**

ibn Abī Dunyā

أبو
المنذر
الرواندي

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Title: Those Who Lived After Death

Version 1.0: Muḥarrām 1448 • July 2026

1st Ebook Edition: 1448H • 2026 CE

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Table of Contents

Translator's Introduction	5
Biography of Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā.....	7
His Name, Lineage, and Birth	7
His Teachers	7
His Students (Those Who Narrated From Him)	9
Scholarly Praise and Status.....	10
His Role as a Royal Tutor	10
The List of His Authored Works.....	12
Translation of Man 'Āsha Ba'da al-Mawt.....	17
The Chain of the Manuscript.....	17
The youth of the Anṣār revived	17
The blind woman's son.....	18
The casualty of Musaylimah.....	24
Rib'ī bin Ḥirāsh's brother speaking	24
The uncle who died with al-Baṭṭāl	26
Ru'bah bint Bījān.....	26
Ṣāliḥ bin Ḥayy's neighbor	27
Punishments for reviling Abū Bakr and 'Umar.....	27
The Juhanī	30
'Umar and the boy born in the grave	31
The man who brayed like a donkey	32
The donkey resurrected for Nubātah bin Yazīd	34
The dead companion aiding the fighter.....	35
Ibn 'Umar witnessing the punishment of the grave.....	36
The Judge of Banī Isrā'īl	38
The affair of 'Abbād in year 66	38

Dāwūd bin Abī Hind's vision	39
Ziyād in Sicily	40
The youth killed by the Roman king	42
‘Abd al-Wāḥid bin Zayd and the maidens of Jannah	43
The grave of Ḥamzah returning the greeting.....	43
Hearing the answers to Munkar and Nakīr	44
The boiling blood of Yaḥyā bin Zakariyyā	44
Muṭarrif bin ‘Abdillāh and Sūrah as-Sajdah	46
Cain suspended at the pool	47
The Pharaoh's family	48
The Imprisoned Father in Antioch	48
Qur’ānic Tafsīr Reports	50
Al-Ḥuwayrith and the Burning Man.....	56
The Heat of Death After One Hundred Years.....	57
‘Īsā Raising Sām bin Nūḥ	57
The Woman Reviving at the Grave.....	58
The Woman of Banī Isrā’īl and Her Sons	58
The Youth Whose Head Recited the Qur’an.....	59
The Head That Condemned a Murderer	59
Righteous and Wicked Deeds Personified	60
Translator's Outroduction	62

Translator's Introduction

All praise is due to Allāh, the Lord of all that exists. We praise Him, seek His aid, and ask for His forgiveness. We seek refuge in Allāh from the evils of our own souls and the wicked consequences of our actions. Whomsoever Allāh guides, none can lead astray, and whomsoever He leaves to stray, none can guide. I bear witness that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allāh alone, without any partners, and I bear witness that Muḥammad (صلى الله عليه وسلم) is His slave and Messenger.

To proceed:

The genre of *Zuhd* (asceticism) and *Raqāʾiq* (heart-softeners) represents the spiritual lifeblood of the early generations of Islām. While establishing the correct methodology and creed (ʿAqīdah) is the unshakeable foundation, the Imāms of the *Salaf* understood that a foundation must support a building—and that building is a heart attached to the Hereafter, terrified of Allāh’s punishment, and entirely detached from the delusion of the worldly life (*ad-Dunyā*).

Among the undisputed masters of compiling these specific sciences was the Imām, the Ḥāfiẓ, and the ascetic, Abū Bakr ʿAbdullāh bin Muḥammad bin ʿUbaydullāh al-Qurashī al-Umawī, famously known as **Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā**. He was a prolific author, widely respected by the scholars of Ḥadīth, and uniquely dedicated to documenting the diseases of the soul and their cures. He authored dozens of highly specialized micro-treatises (*Ajzāʾ*) that served as striking reminders of mortality.

The Subject of the Book

The treatise before you, *Man ʿĀsha Baʿda al-Mawt* (*Those Who Lived After Death*), is one of his most profound and awe-inspiring compilations.

The human intellect is often blinded by the physical world, leading to heedlessness (*Ghaflah*). To shatter this delusion, Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā gathered authentic chains of transmission detailing extraordinary events: people who spoke after their souls were taken, individuals who witnessed the realities of the *Barzakh* (the realm of the grave) during near-death experiences, and the terrifying or beautiful visions seen by those at the very edge of departure.

To the rationalist or the modernist, such reports might seem incomprehensible. However, upon the methodology of *Ahl as-Sunnah wal-Jamā'ah*, we affirm that the power of Allāh is absolute. He grants *Karāmāt* (miracles of the righteous) to His pious servants, and He occasionally lifts the veil of the Unseen (*al-Ghayb*) to serve as a decisive warning for the living. As ‘Ā’ishah (رضي الله عنها) affirmed in this very treatise: **“We used to hear that a man from this Ummah would speak after his death.”** These narrations were not compiled for mere storytelling; they were utilized by the early Imāms to awaken dead hearts. When a believer reads of a dead man warning his companions of the Hellfire, or a deceased youth praising the justice of Abū Bakr and ‘Umar from beneath his burial shroud, the trivialities of this world fade, and the imminence of the Hereafter becomes a striking reality.

We ask Allāh, the Most High, the Most Merciful, to shower His expansive mercy upon the Imām, Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā, for preserving these profound events for the later generations. We ask Him to make this translation a sincere proof for us, not against us, and to use it to soften our hearts, rectify our affairs, and grant us certainty (*Yaqīn*) in the meeting with Him.

May the peace and blessings of Allāh be upon our Prophet Muḥammad, his family, and all of his Companions.

Biography of Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā

His Name, Lineage, and Birth

He is: ‘Abdullāh bin Muḥammad bin ‘Ubayd bin Sufyān bin Qays al-Qurashī, their freed slave (Mawlā) [specifically of Banū Umayyah], al-Baghdādī, the educator (*al-Mu’addib*), the author of widely circulated works. He was born in the year 208 H.

His Teachers

The oldest of his Shaykhs was Sa‘īd bin Sulaymān Sa‘dawayh al-Wāsiṭī. He heard from: ‘Alī bin al-Ja‘d, Khālīd bin Khidāsh, ‘Abdullāh bin Khayrān the companion of al-Mas‘ūdī, and their generation.

Our Shaykh, Abū al-Ḥajjāj al-Ḥāfiẓ [al-Mizzī], has gathered the names of his Shaykhs in the *Mu’jam*, and they are a vast number. Among them are:

Aḥmad bin Ibrāhīm ad-Dawraqī, Aḥmad bin Janāb, Aḥmad bin Ḥātim aṭ-Ṭawīl, Aḥmad bin ‘Abdah aḍ-Ḍabbī, Aḥmad bin ‘Imrān al-Akhnasī. Aḥmad bin ‘Īsā al-Miṣrī, Aḥmad bin Muḥammad bin Ayyūb, Aḥmad bin Muḥammad al-Bartī, Aḥmad bin Manī‘, Aḥmad bin Ziyād Sabalān, Ibrāhīm bin Sa‘īd al-Jawharī, Ibrāhīm bin ‘Abdillāh al-Harawī, Ibrāhīm bin Muḥammad bin ‘Ar‘arah, Ibrāhīm bin Urmah (who was younger than him), and Ishāq bin Abī Isrā’īl. Ismā‘īl bin Ibrāhīm at-Turjumānī, Ismā‘īl al-Qāḍī (who died after him), Ismā‘īl bin ‘Abdillāh bin Zurārah ar-Raqqī, Ismā‘īl bin ‘Ubayd bin Abī Karīmah, Ismā‘īl bin ‘Īsā al-‘Aṭṭār, Bassām bin Yazīd an-Naqqāl, Bashshār bin Mūsā, Bishr bin al-Walīd al-Kindī, Ḥājib bin al-Walīd, and al-Ḥārith bin Surayj an-Naqqāl. Al-Ḥārith bin Abī

Usāmah (his companion), al-Ḥakam bin Mūsā, Khālīd bin Khidāsh, Khalaf bin Sālīm al-Makhramī, Khalaf bin Hishām al-Bazzār, Dāwūd bin Rashīd, Dāwūd bin ‘Amr aḍ-Ḍabbī, ar-Rabī‘ bin Tha‘lab, Zuhayr bin Ḥarb, and Surayj bin Yūnus. Sa‘īd bin Zانبūr al-Hamadānī, Sa‘īd bin Sulaymān al-Makhramī al-Aḥwal, Sa‘īd bin Sulaymān Sa‘dawayh, Sa‘īd bin Muḥammad al-Jarmī, Sulaymān bin Ayyūb the companion of al-Baṣrī, Suwayd bin Sa‘īd, ‘Abdullāh bin Khayrān, and ‘Abdullāh bin ‘Awn al-Kharrāz. ‘Abdullāh bin Mu‘āwiyah al-Jumāhī, ‘Abd al-A‘lā bin Ḥammād, ‘Abd aṣ-Ṣamad bin Yazīd Mardawayh, ‘Abd al-‘Azīz bin Baḥr, ‘Abd al-Muta‘ālī bin Ṭālib, Abū Naṣr bin ‘Abd al-‘Azīz at-Tammār, and ‘Ubaydullāh al-Qawārīrī. ‘Ubaydullāh al-‘Ayshī, ‘Alī bin al-Ja‘d, ‘Ammār bin Naṣr, Abū ‘Ubayd al-Qāsim bin Sallām (who is among his earliest Shaykhs), Kāmil bin Ṭalḥah, Muḥammad bin Ismā‘īl bin Abī Samīnah, Muḥammad bin Bakkār bin ar-Rayyān, and Muḥammad bin Ja‘far al-Madā’inī (narrating from Ḥamzah az-Zayyāt regarding *Iṣṭinā‘ al-Ma‘rūf* [doing good deeds]). Muḥammad bin Ziyād bin al-A‘rābī, Muḥammad bin Sa‘īd al-Kātib, Muḥammad bin Sallām al-Jumāhī, Muḥammad bin aṣ-Ṣabbāḥ ad-Dawlābī, Muḥammad bin aṣ-Ṣabbāḥ al-Jarjarā’ī, Muḥammad bin ‘Āṣim (the owner of the inn, who narrated to him from Ḥarīz bin ‘Uthmān and from Kathīr bin Sulaym), and Muḥammad bin ‘Abbād al-Makkī. Muḥammad bin ‘Abd al-Wāhib al-Ḥārithī, Muḥammad bin ‘Ubayd (his father), Muḥammad bin ‘Imrān bin Abī Laylā al-Anṣārī, Muḥammad bin Yūnus al-Kudaymī, Maḥmūd bin al-Ḥasan al-Warrāq (from his poetry), Maḥmūd bin Muḥammad bin Maḥmūd bin ‘Adī bin Thābit bin Qays bin al-Khaṭīm az-Zafarī, Maṣṣūr bin Abī Muzāḥim, Maḥdī bin Ḥaḥṣ, Mūsā bin Muḥammad bin Ḥayyān al-Baṣrī, an-Naḍr bin Ṭāhir al-Baṣrī, and Nu‘aym bin al-Hayṣam. Hārūn bin Ma‘rūf, al-Haytham bin Khārījah, Yaḥyā bin Ayyūb al-‘Ābid, Yaḥyā bin Durust al-Qurashī, Yaḥyā bin ‘Abd al-Ḥamīd al-Ḥimmānī, Yaḥyā bin ‘Abdawayh (the companion of Shu‘bah), Yaḥyā bin Yūsuf az-Zimmī, Abū Bilāl al-Ash‘arī Mirdās, and Abū ‘Ubaydah bin Fuḍayl bin ‘Iyād.

He also narrates from a vast number of people who are unknown, and from a group of the later scholars, such as Yaḥyā bin Abī Ṭālib, Abū Qilābah ar-Raqāshī, Abū Ḥātim ar-Rāzī, Muḥammad bin Ismāʿīl at-Tirmidhī, and ʿAbbās ad-Dūrī. This is because he traveled very little, so it was difficult for him to narrate certain things, so he would write them down with descending (lower) chains and however they occurred.

His Students (Those Who Narrated From Him)

Those who narrated from him include: Al-Ḥārith bin Abī Usāmah (who was one of his own Shaykhs), Ibn Abī Ḥātim, Aḥmad bin Muḥammad al-Lunbānī, Abū Bakr Aḥmad bin Salmān an-Najjād, and al-Ḥusayn bin Ṣafwān al-Bardhaʿī. Aḥmad bin Khuzaymah, Abū Jaʿfar ʿAbdullāh bin Burayyah al-Hāshimī, Abū Bakr Muḥammad bin ʿAbdillāh ash-Shāfiʿī, ʿĪsā bin Muḥammad at-Ṭūmārī, Abū ʿAlī Aḥmad bin Muḥammad aṣ-Ṣaḥḥāf, Abū al-ʿAbbās bin ʿUqdah, Abū Sahl bin Ziyād, Aḥmad bin Marwān ad-Dīnawarī, and ʿUthmān bin Muḥammad adh-Dhababī. ʿAlī bin al-Faraj bin Abī Rawḥ, Ibrāhīm bin Mūsā bin Jamīl al-Andalusī, Ibrāhīm bin ʿUthmān al-Khashshāb (a Baṣran), Ibrāhīm bin ʿAbdillāh bin al-Junayd (who died before him), Abū al-Ḥusayn Aḥmad bin Muḥammad bin Jaʿfar al-Jawzī, and Ibn Abī Ḥātim. ʿAbd ar-Raḥmān bin Ḥamdān al-Jallāb, Muḥammad bin ʿAbdillāh bin Aḥmad al-Aṣbahānī aṣ-Ṣaffār, Abū Bashīr ad-Dawlābī, Abū Jaʿfar bin al-Bakhtarī, Muḥammad bin Aḥmad bin Khanb al-Bukhārī, Ibn al-Marzubān, Muḥammad bin Khalaf Wakīʿ, and others.

Scholarly Praise and Status

Ibn Mājah narrated from him in his *Tafsīr*.

Ibn Abī Ḥātim said: “I wrote from him alongside my father, and my father said: ‘He is truth-telling (ṣadūq).’”

Al-Khaṭīb said: “He served as the tutor for more than one of the children of the Caliphs.”

Someone else said: “If Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā sat with someone, if he wished, he could make him laugh, and if he wished, he could make him weep at the very same moment, due to his vast expansiveness in knowledge and historical reports.”

Aḥmad bin Kāmil said: “Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā was the tutor of [the Caliph] al-Mu‘taḍid.”

His Role as a Royal Tutor

Abū Bakr bin Shādhān al-Bazzāz said: Abū Dharr al-Qāsim bin Dāwūd narrated to us, saying: Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā narrated to me, saying: **“Al-Muktafī entered upon al-Muwaffaq holding his writing tablet in his hand. So he said: ‘What is the matter with you holding your tablet in your hand?’ He replied: ‘My servant boy died, so he has rested from the Qur’ān school (al-Kuttāb).’ He [al-Muwaffaq] said: ‘These are not your own words!’ Ar-Rashīd had commanded that the tablets of his children be presented to him, so they were presented to him. He said to his son: ‘What is the matter with your servant boy that your tablet is not with him?’ He (his son) said: ‘He died and rested from the school.’ He [responded to his son and] said: ‘Is death easier for you than the school?’ He (his son) said: ‘Yes.’ He said: ‘Then**

leave the school.”“ He [al-Muktafi] said: “Then I came to him, and he said: ‘How is your love for your tutor [Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā]?’ I said: ‘How could I not love him, when he was the first to open my tongue with the remembrance of Allāh? And along with that, if you wish, he makes you laugh, and if you wish, he makes you weep.’ He said: ‘O Rāshid, bring him here.’ So he brought me, and I began [narrating] the histories of the Caliphs and their admonitions, so he wept a severe weeping. Then I began and mentioned the rare anecdotes of the Bedouins, so he laughed a great deal, then he said to me: ‘You have exposed me, you have exposed me!’”

The List of His Authored Works

[Adh-Dhahabī said:] I have come across the following from the authored works of Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā: *Al-Qanā‘ah* (Contentment), *Qaṣr al-Amal* (Shortening One’s Hopes), *Mujābū ad-Da‘wah* (Those Whose Supplications Are Answered), *At-Tawakkul* (Reliance), *Al-Wajal* (Fear), *Dhamm al-Malāhī* (The Censure of Amusements), *Aṣ-Ṣamt* (Silence), *Al-Faraj Ba‘da ash-Shiddah* (Relief After Hardship), *Qirā aḍ-Ḍayf* (Hospitality to the Guest), *Man ‘Āsha Ba‘da al-Mawt* (Those Who Lived After Death), *Al-Muḥtaḍarīn* (Those at the Point of Death), *Al-Mudārah* (Accommodating People - though incomplete), *Muḥāsabat an-Nafs* (Taking the Soul to Account), *Dhamm al-Muskir* (The Censure of Intoxicants), *Al-Yaqīn* (Certainty), *At-Tawbah* (Repentance), *Ash-Shukr* (Gratitude), *Al-Mawt* (Death), *Al-Qubūr* (The Graves), *Al-‘Uzlah* (Isolation), and other things.

The alphabetical arrangement of his authored works:

- **The Letter Alif (إ):** *Kitāb Al-Adab* (The Book of Manners), *Iṣṭinā‘ al-Ma‘rūf* (Doing Good Deeds), *Al-Ashrāf* (The Nobles), *Akhbār Ḍaygham* (The Reports of Ḍaygham), *Iṣlāḥ al-Māl* (Rectifying Wealth), *Al-Anwā’* (The Stars/Seasons), *Akhbār al-Mulūk* (The Reports of the Kings), *Al-Akhlāq* (Character), *Al-Ikhwān* (Brotherhood), *Al-Infirād* (Solitude), *Akhbār ath-Thawrī* (The Reports of ath-Thawrī), *Al-Alwiyah* (The Banners), *Al-Awliyā’* (The Close Friends of Allāh), *Al-Amr bil-Ma‘rūf* (Enjoining the Good), *Al-Alḥān* (Melodies), *Al-Aḥzān* (Sorrows), *Akhbār Uways* (The Reports of Uways), *Akhbār Mu‘āwiyah* (The Reports of Mu‘āwiyah), *Al-Uḍḥiyah* (The Sacrifice), *Al-Ikhlāṣ* (Sincerity), *Al-Ayyām wal-Layālī* (The Days and the Nights), *Ahwāl al-Qiyāmah* (The Terrors of the Resurrection), *A‘lām an-Nubuwwah* (The Signs of Prophethood), *Inzāl al-Ḥājah billāh* (Placing One’s Needs with Allāh), *Akhbār Quraysh* (The Reports of Quraysh), *Akhbār al-A‘rāb* (The Reports of the Bedouins), *I‘ṭā’ as-Sā’il* (Giving to the Asker),

Inqilāb az-Zamān (The Overturning of Time), *A‘qāb as-Surūr* (The Aftermath of Joy), *Al-Aḥzān wal-Bukkā’* (Sorrows and Weeping).

- **The Letter Tā’ (ت):** *At-Tawbah* (Repentance), *At-Tahajjud* (The Night Vigil), *At-Tafakkur wal-I‘tibār* (Reflection and Contemplation), *At-Ta‘āzī* (Condolences), *Tārīkh al-Khulafā’* (The History of the Caliphs), *At-Tārīkh* (History), *Taghayyur al-Ikhwān* (The Changing of Brothers), *Taghyīr az-Zamān* (The Changing of Time), *At-Taqwā* (Piety), *Ta‘bīr ar-Ru’yā* (Dream Interpretation), *At-Tashammus* (Basking in the Sun), *At-Tawakkul* (Reliance).
- **The Letter Jīm (ج):** *Al-Jū‘* (Hunger), *Al-Jihād* (Striving in the Path of Allāh), *Al-Jufāt ‘inda al-Mawt* (The Harsh Ones at Death), *Al-Jirān* (The Neighbors).
- **The Letter Ḥā’ (ح):** *Ḥusn az-Zann* (Having Good Expectations), *Al-Ḥadhar wash-Shafaqah* (Caution and Pity), *Ḥilm al-Ḥukamā’* (The Forbearance of the Wise), *Al-Ḥilm* (Forbearance), *Ḥilm al-Aḥnaf* (The Forbearance of al-Aḥnaf), *Ḥurūf Khalaf* (The Letters of Khalaf), *Al-Ḥawā’ij* (Needs).
- **The Letter Khā’ (خ):** *Al-Khulafā’* (The Caliphs), *Al-Khāfiqayn* (The Two Horizons), *Al-Khumūl* (Obscurity), *Al-Khubz al-Khātīm* (The Bread of the Seal).
- **The Letter Dāl (د):** *Dalā’il an-Nubuwwah* (The Proofs of Prophethood), *Ad-Dayn wal-Wafā’* (Debt and Fulfillment), *Ad-Du‘ā’* (Supplication).
- **The Letter Dhāl (ذ):** *Dhamm ad-Dunyā* (The Censure of the Worldly Life), *Dhamm ash-Shahawāt* (The Censure of Desires), *Dhamm al-Muskir* (The Censure of Intoxicants), *Dhamm al-Baghy* (The Censure of Transgression), *Dhamm al-Ghībah* (The Censure of Backbiting), *Dhamm al-Ḥasad* (The Censure of Envy), *Dhamm al-Faqr* (The Censure of Poverty), *Dhamm ar-Riyā’* (The Censure of Showing Off), *Dhamm ar-Ribā* (The Censure of Usury),

Dhamm aḍ-Ḍaḥik (The Censure of Laughter), *Dhamm al-Bukhl* (The Censure of Stinginess), *Adh-Dhikr* (Remembrance).

- **The Letter Rāʾ (ر):** *Ar-Ruhbān* (The Monks), *Ar-Rukhṣah fī as-Samāʿ* (The Concession Regarding Listening), *Ar-Ramy* (Archery/Throwing), *Ar-Rahāʾin* (The Hostages), *Ar-Riḍā* (Being Pleased), *Ar-Riqqah* (Softness of the Heart).
- **The Letters Zāy (ز), Sīn (س), & Shīn (ش):** *Az-Zuhd* (Asceticism), *Az-Zafīr* (Sighing), *As-Sunnah* (The Sunnah), *As-Sakhāʾ* (Generosity), *Ash-Shukr* (Gratitude), *Ash-Shayb* (White Hair), *Sharaf al-Faqr* (The Nobility of Poverty).
- **The Letter Ṣād (ص):** *Aṣ-Ṣamt* (Silence), *Aṣ-Ṣadaqah* (Charity), *Ṣadaqat al-Fiṭr* (The Charity of Fiṭr), *Aṣ-Ṣabr* (Patience), *Ṣifat al-Jannah* (The Description of Paradise), *Ṣifat an-Nār* (The Description of the Fire), *Ṣifat an-Nabī* (The Description of the Prophet صلى الله عليه وسلم), *Aṣ-Ṣalāh ʿalā an-Nabī* (Sending Blessings upon the Prophet).
- **The Letter Ṭāʾ (ط):** *Aṭ-Ṭabaqāt* (The Classes of Scholars), *Aṭ-Ṭawāʿin* (Plagues).
- **The Letter ʿAyn (ع):** *Al-ʿUzlah* (Isolation), *Al-ʿAzāʾ* (Condolences), *ʿUqūbat al-Anbiyāʾ* (The Punishment of the Prophets), *Al-ʿAql* (The Intellect), *Al-ʿAwāʾid* (The Returns/Benefits), *Al-ʿUqūbāt* (Punishments), *Al-ʿIyāl* (Dependents), *Al-ʿUbbād* (The Worshippers), *Al-ʿAwdh* (Seeking Refuge), *Al-ʿĪdayn* (The Two ʿĪds), *Al-ʿIlm* (Knowledge), *ʿĀshūrāʾ* (The Day of ʿĀshūrāʾ), *Al-ʿAfw* (Pardon), *Aṭ-ṭāʾ as-Sāʾil* (Giving to the Asker), *Al-ʿUmr wash-Shabāb* (Life and Youth).
- **The Letter Fāʾ (ف):** *Faḍl al-ʿAbbās* (The Virtue of al-ʿAbbās), *Al-Fatwā* (Verdicts), *Al-Faraj Baʿda ash-Shiddah* (Relief After Hardship), *Faḍl al-ʿAshr* (The Virtue of the Ten Days), *Faḍl Ramaḍān* (The Virtue of Ramaḍān),

Faḍā'il ʿAlī (The Virtues of ʿAlī), *Faḍl Lā ilāha illallāh* (The Virtue of 'There is no deity worthy of worship except Allāh'), *Al-Fawā'id* (Benefits), *Al-Funūn* (Arts/Branches of Knowledge), *Faḍā'il al-Qur'ān* (The Virtues of the Qur'ān).

- **The Letter Qāf (ق):** *Al-Qiṣāṣ* (Retribution), *Qaḍā' al-Ḥawā'ij* (Fulfilling Needs), *Qaṣr al-Amal* (Shortening One's Hopes), *Qirā ad-Ḍayf* (Hospitality to the Guest), *Al-Qubūr* (The Graves), *Al-Qanā'ah* (Contentment).
- **The Letter Kāf (ك):** *Karāmāt al-Awliyā'* (The Miracles of the Close Friends of Allāh).
- **The Letter Mīm (م):** *Al-Mudārah* (Accommodating People), *Man ʿĀsha Ba'da al-Mawt* (Those Who Lived After Death), *Al-Muḥtaḍarīn* (Those at the Point of Death), *Al-Maraḍ wal-Kaffārāt* (Illness and Expiations), *Al-Mawt* (Death), *Al-Mutamannīn* (Those Who Wish), *Makā'id ash-Shayṭān* (The Plots of Satan), *Al-Maṭar* (The Rain), *Al-Manāmāt* (Dreams), *Maqtal ʿAlī* (The Murder of ʿAlī), *Maqtal ʿUthmān* (The Murder of ʿUthmān), *Maqtal al-Ḥusayn* (The Murder of al-Ḥusayn), *Maqtal Ṭalḥah* (The Murder of Ṭalḥah), *Maqtal az-Zubayr* (The Murder of az-Zubayr), *Maqtal Ibn az-Zubayr* (The Murder of Ibn az-Zubayr), *Maqtal Ibn Jubayr* (The Murder of Ibn Jubayr), *Kitāb al-Muruwwah* (The Book of Chivalry/Manhood), *Al-Majūs* (The Magians), *Mu'āraḍ al-Kalām* (The Contradictions in Speech), *Al-Mamlūkīn* (The Slaves/Owned Ones), *Al-Maghāzī* (The Military Expeditions), *Al-Muntaẓam* (The Ordered/Arranged), *Al-Manāsik* (The Rites of Pilgrimage), *Makārim al-Akhlāq* (Noble Character), *Mujābū ad-Da'wah* (Those Whose Supplications are Answered), *Muḥāsabat an-Nafs* (Taking the Soul to Account), *Al-Ma'ishah* (Livelihood).
- **The Letter Nūn (ن):** *An-Nawādir* (Rare Anecdotes), *An-Nawāzi'* (Inclinations/Urges).

- **The Letter Hāʾ (هـ):** *Al-Hamm wal-Ḥuzn* (Anxiety and Sorrow), *Al-Hadāyā* (Gifts).
- **The Letter Wāw (و):** *Al-Waraʿ* (Pious Caution), *Al-Waṣāyā* (Wills/Advises), *Al-Waqf wal-Ibtidāʿ* (Stopping and Starting [in Recitation]), *Al-Wajal* (Fear/Apprehension).
- **The Letter Yāʾ (ي):** *Al-Yaqīn* (Certainty).

[Taken From *Siyar Aʿlām an-Nubalāʾ* 13/397]

Translation of Man ‘Āsha Ba‘da al-Mawt

The Chain of the Manuscript

The Shaykh, the Imām, the Trustworthy, Taqī ad-Dīn Aḥmad bin Ḥamzah bin ‘Alī bin al-Ḥasan as-Sulamī ad-Dimashqī narrated to us, [while] reading upon him in the Jāmi‘ [Grand Mosque] of Damascus—may Allāh the Exalted protect it—on the date of [left blank in the manuscript]. He said: The two Shaykhs, Abū ‘Abdullāh Yaḥyā and Abū Ghālib Aḥmad, the sons of Abū ‘Alī al-Ḥasan bin ‘Abdullāh bin al-Bannā’ informed us in their two books; and the Shaykh, the Imām, Abū al-‘Abbās Aḥmad bin Muḥammad bin ‘Abd al-‘Azīz al-Makkī (رضي الله عنه) informed us, both saying: Our father, the Shaykh, the Imām, Abū ‘Alī al-Ḥasan bin Aḥmad bin ‘Abdullāh bin al-Bannā’ informed us, saying: Abū al-Ḥusayn ‘Alī bin Muḥammad bin ‘Abdullāh bin Bishrān informed us, saying: Abū ‘Alī al-Ḥusayn bin Ṣafwān al-Bardha‘ī informed us, [while] reading upon him in [the month of] Dhūl-Qi‘dah of the year 329, saying: Abū Bakr ‘Abdullāh bin Muḥammad bin ‘Ubaydullāh Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā narrated to us, saying:

The youth of the Anṣār revived

Khālīd bin Khidāsh bin ‘Ajlān al-Muhallabī and Ismā‘īl bin Ibrāhīm bin Bassām narrated to us, both saying: Ṣāliḥ al-Murrī narrated to us, from Thābit al-Bunānī, from Anas bin Mālīk, who said: **“I visited a young man from the Anṣār [who was ill], and it was not long before he died. So we closed his eyes and spread a garment over him. Then one of us said to his mother: ‘Seek the reward [from Allāh for losing] him.’ She said: ‘Has he died?’ We said: ‘Yes.’ She said: ‘Is what you [all] are saying true?’ We said: ‘Yes.’ So she stretched her hands towards the heaven and said: ‘O Allāh, verily I believed in You, and I migrated to Your Messenger, so whenever a severe hardship befell**

me, I supplicated to You, and You relieved it. So I ask You, O Allāh, do not place this calamity upon me today.' He [Anas] said: So he [the dead youth] uncovered the garment from his face, and we did not leave until we had eaten, and he had eaten with us.”¹

The blind woman's son

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad bin Muḥammad bin al-Aswad at-Tamīmī narrated to me, from Abū an-Naḍr Hāshim bin al-Qāsim, from Ṣāliḥ al-Murrī, who said: I narrated this to Ḥafṣ bin an-Naḍr as-Sulamī, and he marveled at it. Then he met me the following Friday and said: “I marveled at your ḥadīth, then I met Rabī‘ah bin Kulthūm and he narrated to me that a man narrated to him that he had an old, deaf, blind, and crippled female neighbor who had no one from the people [to look after her] except a son of hers, who was the one striving to provide for her. Then he died, so we came to her and called out to her: **“Seek the reward for your calamity from Allāh, the Blessed and Exalted.”** She said: **“And what is that? Has my son died? My Lord is more merciful to me; He would not take my son from me while I am deaf, blind, and crippled, having no one. My Lord is more merciful to me than that.”** He said: **‘I said [to myself]: “She has lost her mind.”** So I went to the market, bought his shroud, and came back with it, and [to my surprise] he was sitting [up alive].’”²

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Abū Muslim ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān bin Yūnus narrated to us, saying: ‘Abdullāh bin Idrīs narrated to us, from Ismā‘īl bin Abī Khālīd, who said: Yazīd bin an-Nu‘mān bin Bashīr came to us at the gathering of

¹ Collected by al-Bayhaqī in *Dalā'il an-Nubuwwah* (6/50) and Abū Nu‘aym in *Dalā'il an-Nubuwwah* (no. 560). The chain is weak due to the presence of Ṣāliḥ al-Murrī, who was a righteous ascetic but graded weak in his memorization of Ḥadīth.

² Collected by al-Bayhaqī in *Dalā'il an-Nubuwwah* (6/50-51). The chain is weak (*ḍa‘īf*) due to the transmitter Ṣāliḥ al-Murrī.

al-Qāsim bin ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān with a letter from his father, an-Nu‘mān bin Bashīr [which read]: “In the Name of Allāh, the Most Merciful, the Bestower of Mercy. From an-Nu‘mān bin Bashīr to Umm ‘Abdillāh bint Abī Hāshim. Peace be upon you. Verily, I praise Allāh to you, the One besides whom there is no deity worthy of worship. You wrote to me asking me to write to you regarding the affair of Zayd bin Khārijah. And regarding his affair: a pain afflicted him in his throat while he was, on that day, among the healthiest of the people of Madīnah. He died between the first prayer [Dhuhr] and the ‘Aṣr prayer. So we laid him on his back and covered him with two garments and a cloak. Then, a comer came to me in my place [of prayer] while I was glorifying Allāh after the Maghrib prayer, and he said: ‘Verily, Zayd has spoken after his death.’ So I went to him hurriedly, and a group from the Anṣār had attended to him, while he was saying—or it was being said upon his tongue: ‘The middle one [‘Umar] is the most resilient of the people, the one who did not fear the blame of a blamer for the sake of Allāh, the one who did not command the people such that their strong would devour their weak; [He is] ‘Abdullāh, the Commander of the Believers, truth, truth. That was in the first Book.’ Then he said: “Uthmān, the Commander of the Believers, and he pardons the people from many sins. Two nights [i.e., years] have passed, and four [years] remain. Then the people differed, and they ate [i.e., destroyed] one another; so there was no order, and the sacred precincts were violated. Then the believers refrained and returned [to the truth], and they said: “The Book of Allāh and His Decree.” O people, turn towards your commander, listen, and obey. For whoever turns away, let him not pledge for blood [i.e., let him not seek retaliation or shed blood]. The command of Allāh is a decree perfectly determined. Allāh is the Greatest. This is Paradise, and this is the Fire, and the Prophets and the truthful ones are saying: Peace be upon you. O ‘Abdullāh bin Rawāḥah, have you

perceived Khārijah for his father and Sa‘d? The two who were killed on the Day of Uḥud.

كَأَلَا إِنَّمَا لَطَىٰ ۖ نَزَاعَةً لِّلشَّوَىٰ ۖ تَدْعُوا مَن أَدْبَرَ وَتَوَلَّىٰ ۖ وَجَمَعَ فَأَوْعَىٰ

{But no (there will be no ransom for the criminals)! Indeed, it will be the Fire (of Hell). Which strips the exteriors (of men, the scalp, skin, flesh, nerves and tendons, with its intense heat). It invites he who turned his back (on the truth) and turned away from (obedience) (drawing and plucking him). And (who) collected (wealth) and hoarded (it)} [70:15-18].’

Then his voice faded. So I asked the group about what preceded me from his speech, and they said: ‘We heard him say: “Listen silently, listen silently.” So we looked at one another, and the sound was coming from under the garments. We uncovered his face, and he said: “This is Aḥmad [Muḥammad], the Messenger of Allāh. Peace be upon you, O Messenger of Allāh, and the mercy of Allāh and His blessings.” Then he said: “Abū Bakr aṣ-Ṣiddīq, the Trustworthy, the Caliph of the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم). He was weak in his body, strong in the command of Allāh; truth, truth, and it was in the first Book.”‘

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: ‘Alī bin al-Ja‘d narrated to us: ‘Ikrimah bin Ibrāhīm informed me, from ‘Abd al-Malik bin ‘Umayr, who said: I read a letter that was with Ḥabīb bin Sālim, written by an-Nu‘mān bin Bashīr to Umm Khālīd: “To proceed: Verily, you wrote asking me about the ḥadīth of Zayd bin Khārijah who spoke after his death...” and he mentioned [a narration] similar to it.

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Ziyād bin Ayyūb narrated to us, saying: Shabābah narrated to us, saying: Abū Bakr bin ‘Ayyāsh narrated to us, from Mubashshir, the freed slave of the family of Sa‘īd bin al-‘Āṣ, from az-Zuhrī, from Sa‘īd bin al-Musayyib, who said: “Death came to a man from the Anṣār and

he died. So they covered him, then he spoke and said: ‘Abū Bakr is strong in the command of Allāh, weak in what the eye sees [i.e., physically]. And ‘Umar is the trustworthy. And ‘Uthmān is upon their path. Justice has been severed; the strong have devoured the weak.’“

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad bin Ḥammād ar-Rāzī narrated to us, saying: I heard Hishām bin ‘Ubaydillāh, from Rawāḥ bin ‘Aṭā’ al-Anṣārī, who said: My father narrated to me, from Anas bin Mālīk, who said: **“When Zayd bin Khārijah died, the Anṣār competed over washing him until there was almost a dispute between them. Then their opinion settled on washing him the first two washes, then a master from every clan would enter and pour water over him in the third wash. And I was entered among those who entered. When we went to pour [water] over him, he spoke and said: ‘Two [years] have passed and four remain. Then their rich devoured[i.e., exploited] their poor, so they dispersed and had no order. Abū Bakr was gentle and merciful to the believers, severe against the disbelievers, not fearing the blame of a blamer for the sake of Allāh. And ‘Umar was gentle and merciful, severe against the disbelievers, not fearing the blame of a blamer for the sake of Allāh. And ‘Uthmān is gentle and merciful to the believers, and you are upon the path of ‘Uthmān, so listen and obey.’ Then he faded, and his tongue was moving while his body was dead.”**

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Aḥmad bin Muḥammad bin Abī Bakr narrated to us, saying: Abū Hammām aṣ-Ṣalt bin Muḥammad narrated to us, saying: Maslamah bin ‘Alqamah narrated to us, from Dāwūd bin Abī Hind, from Yazīd bin Nāfi‘, from Ḥabīb bin Sālim, from an-Nu‘mān bin Bashīr, who said: **“Zayd bin Khārijah was from the nobles of the Anṣār, and his father was Khārijah bin Sa‘d. When Abū Bakr migrated, he stayed with him in his house and married his daughter, the daughter of Khārijah. She had a husband named Sa‘d. So his father and his brother Sa‘d bin Khārijah were killed on the Day**

of Uḥud. He [Zayd] remained after them during the life of the Prophet (صلى الله عليه وسلم) and the Caliphate of Abū Bakr and ʿUmar, and for [a few] years of the Caliphate of ʿUthmān. While he was walking on one of the paths of Madīnah, between Dhuhr and ʿAṣr, he collapsed and died. The Anṣār were informed of him, so they came to him and carried him to his house. They covered him with a cloak and two garments, and in the house were women from the Anṣār weeping over him, and men from their men. He remained in his condition until, when it was between Maghrib and the late ʿIshāʾ, they heard a voice saying: ‘Listen silently.’ They looked, and the sound was from under the garments. They uncovered his face and chest, and the speaker was saying upon his tongue: ‘Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم), the unlettered, the seal of the Prophets, there is no Prophet after him; that was in the first Book.’ Then the speaker said upon his tongue: ‘Truth, truth, truth.’ Then the speaker said upon his tongue: ‘Abū Bakr is the Caliph of the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم), the Truthful, the Trustworthy, who was weak in his body, strong in the command of Allāh; that was in the first Book.’ Then the speaker said upon his tongue: ‘Truth, truth, truth.’ Then he said: ‘The middle one [ʿUmar] is the most resilient of the people, who did not fear the blame of a blamer for the sake of Allāh, who prevented the people such that their strong would eat their weak; [He is] ʿAbdullāh, ʿUmar, the Commander of the Believers; that was in the first Book.’ Then the speaker said upon his tongue: ‘Truth, truth, truth.’ Then he said: ‘ʿUthmān is the Commander of the Believers, and he is merciful to the believers, and he pardons the people regarding many sins. Two nights have passed—the two years were made [to feel] like two nights—and four remain [meaning four years]. And there is no order for them, the sacred precincts were violated, the Hour drew near, and the people devoured one another. Then the believers refrained and returned, and said: “O people, the Book of Allāh and His decree. So turn towards your

commander, listen to him and obey, for he is upon their path. So whoever turns away after that, let him not pledge for blood [i.e., do not seek revenge]. The command of Allāh is a perfectly determined decree” [(saying it) twice]. Then he said: ‘This is the Fire, and this is Paradise, and these are the Prophets and the Martyrs. Peace be upon you, O ‘Abdullāh bin Rawāḥah, have you perceived Khārijah and Sa‘d for his father and brother who were killed on the Day of Uḥud?’ Then he said:

كَلَّا إِنَّهَا لَأَطَى ۖ نَزَاعَةٌ لِلشَّوَى ۖ تَدْعُوا مَنْ أَدْبَرَ وَتَوَلَّى ۖ وَجَمَعَ فَأَوْعَى

{But no (there will be no ransom for the criminals)! Indeed, it will be the Fire (of Hell). Which strips the exteriors (of men, the scalp, skin, flesh, nerves and tendons, with its intense heat). It invites he who turned his back (on the truth) and turned away from (obedience) (drawing and plucking him). And (who) collected (wealth) and hoarded (it)} [70:15-18].’

Then he said: ‘This is the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم), Peace be upon you, O Messenger of Allāh, and the mercy of Allāh and His blessings.’“ An-Nu‘mān said: “So it was said to me: ‘Verily, Zayd bin Khārijah has spoken after his death.’ So I came stepping over the necks of the people, and I sat at his head, and I caught [the end] of his speech while he was saying: ‘The middle one is the most resilient of the people...’ until the ḥadīth concluded. And I asked the people: ‘What was [said] before me?’ and they informed me.”³

³ Decisively established. Collected by al-Bayhaqī in *Dalā’il* (6/53-55), aṭ-Ṭabarānī in *al-Muḥjam al-Kabīr* (5/119), and al-Ḥākim in *al-Mustadrak* (3/473). Al-Ḥāfiẓ Ibn Ḥajar graded its core chains as authentic (*ṣaḥīḥ*) in *al-Iṣābah* (2/532). As well as the 4 narrations above it.

The casualty of Musaylimah

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Khalaf bin Hishām al-Bazzār narrated to us: Khālīd aṭ-Ṭaḥḥān narrated to us, from Ḥuṣayn, from ‘Abdullāh bin ‘Ubayd al-Anṣārī that a man from the casualties of Musaylimah [the false prophet] spoke (i.e. after death) and said: **‘Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allāh (صلی الله علیه وسلم), Abū Bakr is the Truthful, ‘Uthmān is the gentle, the merciful.’**⁴

Rib‘ī bin Ḥirāsh’s brother speaking

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: My father narrated to me, saying: Sufyān bin ‘Uyaynah narrated to us, from ‘Abd al-Malik bin ‘Umayr, from Rib‘ī bin Ḥirāsh. Then he said: And Muḥammad bin Bakkār narrated to us, saying: Ḥaḥṣ bin ‘Umar narrated to us, from ‘Abd al-Malik bin ‘Umayr, from Rib‘ī bin Ḥirāsh—and this is the wording of Ibn Bakkār—who said: **“We were three brothers, and the middle of us was the most worshipful, the most fasting, and the best of us. I went away on a journey to the Sawād, then I came back to my family, and they said: ‘Catch your brother, for he is in the throes of death.’ So I went out running to him, and I reached him when he had already passed and was covered with a garment. I sat at his head weeping over him. He raised his hand, uncovered the garment from his face, and said: ‘Peace be upon you.’ I said: ‘O my brother, is there life after death?’ He said: ‘Yes. Verily, I met my Lord (عز وجل) and He met me with rest and provision [or sweet scents], and a Lord who is not angry. And He clothed me in green garments of fine silk and heavy brocade. And I found the affair to be easier than what you [all] reckon [(saying it) three times]. So act and do not slacken [(saying it) three times]. Verily, I met the Messenger of Allāh (صلی الله علیه وسلم) and he swore that he would not depart until I come to him, so hasten my**

⁴ Collected by al-Bayhaqī in *Dalāʾil* (6/56).

preparation [for burial].’ Then he was extinguished [i.e., he passed away again], and it was faster than a pebble if it were thrown into the water. So I said: ‘Hasten the preparation of my brother.’“

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Ya‘qūb bin ‘Ubayd narrated to me, saying: Yazīd bin Hārūn informed us, al-Mas‘ūdī informed us, from ‘Abd al-Malik bin ‘Umayr, from Rib‘ī bin Ḥirāsh, who said: **“A brother of mine died, he was the most fasting among us on the hot day, and the most standing [in prayer] on the cold night...”** then he mentioned the story and added to it, saying: **“So that reached ‘Ā’ishah (رضي الله عنها), and she affirmed it and said: ‘We used to hear that a man from this Ummah would speak after his death.’“**

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Surayj bin Yūnus narrated to us, saying: Khālīd bin Nāfi‘ narrated to us, saying: ‘Alī bin ‘Ubaydillāh al-Ghaṭafānī and Ḥaṣṣ bin Yazīd narrated to us, both saying: It reached us that Ibn Ḥirāsh had sworn that he would never laugh until he knew whether he was in Paradise or in the Fire. He remained like that, no one could make him laugh, until he laughed when he died... then he mentioned [a narration] similar to the ḥadīth of ‘Abd al-Malik bin ‘Umayr, except that he said: **“So that reached ‘Ā’ishah (رضي الله عنها), and she said: ‘The brother of Banī ‘Abs has spoken the truth, may Allāh have mercy upon him. I heard the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم) saying: “A man from my Ummah will speak after death from the best of the Tābi‘īn.”“**

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad bin al-Ḥusayn narrated to me, saying: Muḥammad bin Ja‘far bin ‘Awn narrated to us, saying: Bakr bin Muḥammad al-‘Ābid informed me, from al-Ḥārith al-Ghanawī, who said: **“Rabī‘ bin Ḥirāsh swore that his teeth would never show in a laugh until he knew where his destination was.”** So he did not laugh except after his death. **“And his brother Rib‘ī swore after him that he would not laugh until he knew whether he was in Paradise or in the Fire.”** Al-Ḥārith al-Ghanawī said: **“The**

one who washed him informed me that he kept smiling on his bed while we were washing him until we finished with him.”⁵

The uncle who died with al-Baṭṭāl

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Abū Zayd an-Numayrī narrated to us, saying: Abū ‘Āṣim narrated to us, saying: My father informed me, saying: **“My maternal uncle lost consciousness, so we covered him with a garment, and we stood up to wash him. He uncovered the garment from his face and said: ‘O Allāh, do not cause me to die until You grant me [to participate in] a military expedition in Your path.’ So he lived after that until he was killed with al-Baṭṭāl.”**⁶

Ru’bah bint Bījān

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad bin ‘Uthmān al-‘Ijlī narrated to us, saying: Abū Usāmah narrated to us, saying: ‘Uqbah bin ‘Ammār al-‘Absī narrated to me: Mughīrah bin Ḥadhaf narrated to us, from Ru’bah the daughter of Bījān that she fell severely ill until she died in their estimation. So they washed her and shrouded her, then she moved and looked at them, and said: **‘Receive glad tidings, for I found the affair to be easier than what you [all] used to frighten me with. And I found that a severer of kinship ties will not enter Paradise, nor an addict to alcohol, nor a polytheist.’**⁷

⁵ Authentic (*Ṣaḥīḥ*). Collected by al-Bayhaqī in *Dalā’il* (6/57) and Imām Aḥmad in his *Musnad* (6/120). As well as the 3 narrations above it.

⁶ Mentioned by Ibn ‘Asākir in *Tārīkh Dimashq* (10/333) within the chronicles of the Roman expeditions.

⁷ Collected by Abū Nu‘aym in *Ḥilyat al-Awliyā’* (10/58) and Ibn al-Jawzī in *Ṣifāt aṣ-Ṣafwāh*.

Ṣāliḥ bin Ḥayy's neighbor

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad bin ‘Alī bin al-Ḥasan bin Shaqīq narrated to me, saying: Ibrāhīm bin al-Ash‘ath narrated to us, from Sufyān bin ‘Uyaynah, who said: I heard Ṣāliḥ bin Ḥayy saying: A neighbor of mine informed me that a man’s soul was taken up and his deeds were presented to him. He said: **“I did not see [a record of] myself seeking forgiveness from a sin except that it was forgiven for me. And I did not see a sin that I did not seek forgiveness from except that I found it exactly as it was. He said: Even a pomegranate seed I had picked up one day, a good deed was written for me because of it. And I stood one night praying, and I raised my voice, so a neighbor of mine heard it and he stood up and prayed, so a good deed was written for me because of it. And I gave a poor person a dirham one day while in the presence of some people, and I only gave it to him because of them, so I found it to be neither for me nor against me [since it lacked sincerity].”**⁸

Punishments for reviling Abū Bakr and ‘Umar

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Yaḥyā bin Yūsuf az-Zimmī narrated to us, saying: Shu‘ayb bin Ṣafwān narrated to us, from ‘Abd al-Malik bin ‘Umayr, who said: **“There was a man in Kūfah who would provide shrouds. A man died, so he was informed, and he took a shroud and went until he entered upon the dead man while he was covered. He took a breath and threw the garment from his face and said: ‘They deceived me, they destroyed me! The Fire! They destroyed me, the Fire!’ So we said to him: ‘Say, Lā ilāha illallāh.’ He said: ‘I am not able to say it.’ It was asked: ‘And why?’ He said: ‘Because of my reviling of Abū Bakr and ‘Umar.’”**

⁸ Collected by Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā in his other work, *Muḥāsabat an-Nafs* (no. 22).

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: And al-Walīd bin Shujā‘ bin al-Walīd as-Sakūnī narrated to me, saying: My father narrated to us, saying: I heard Khalaf bin Ḥawshab saying:”A man died in al-Madā’in, so when they covered him with his garment, some of the people stood up and some of them remained. Then he moved the garment—or the garment moved—so he took it and uncovered it from him, and said: ‘A people with dyed beards in this mosque [(meaning the mosque of al-Madā’in)] curse Abū Bakr and ‘Umar (رضي الله عنهم) and free themselves from them; the ones who came to me to take my soul curse them and free themselves from them.’ We said: ‘O so-and-so, perhaps you were afflicted with some of that [ideology]?’ He said: ‘I seek forgiveness from Allāh, I seek forgiveness from Allāh.’ Then it was as if there was a pebble and he was struck with it [i.e., he instantly fell back dead].”

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: My father (رحمه الله) and al-Ḥusayn bin al-Ḥasan narrated to us, both saying: Waḍḍāḥ bin Ḥassān al-Anbārī narrated to us, saying: ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān al-Muḥāribī narrated to us, saying: Abū al-Khaṣīb narrated to me, saying: “I was a butcher, and I would not hear of a dead person who died except that I shrouded him. So a man came to me and said: ‘There is a dead person here who has died and he has no shroud.’ So I said to a companion of mine: ‘Let us go.’ So we went and came to them, and they were sitting with a dead person covered, and upon his stomach was a brick or clay. I said: ‘Will you not begin washing him?’ They said: ‘He has no shroud.’ So I said to my companion: ‘Go, and let us bring a shroud.’ So he went, and I sat with the people. While we were sitting, he suddenly jumped up, threw the brick, or clay, from his stomach, and sat up saying: ‘The Fire, the Fire!’ So I said: ‘Say, Lā ilāha illallāh.’ He said: ‘It is of no benefit to me. May Allāh curse the Shaykhs in Kūfah, they deceived me until I reviled Abū Bakr and ‘Umar.’ Then he fell down dead. So I said: ‘By Allāh, I will not shroud him.’

So I stood up and did not shroud him.” So Ibn Hubayrah the Elder sent for me, asking me to narrate this ḥadīth to him, so I narrated it to him.

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Ismā‘īl bin Asad narrated to us: Khalaf bin Tamīm narrated to us: Bashīr Abū al-Khaṣīb narrated to us, saying: “I was a wealthy merchant, and I used to live in the cities of Kisrā, and that was during the time of the plague of Ibn Hubayrah. An employee of mine named Ashraf came to me and said: ‘There is a dead man here in one of the inns of al-Madā’in for whom no shroud can be found.’ So I rode my animal until I entered that inn, and I was directed to a dead man with a brick on his stomach, and around him was a group of his companions mentioning his worship and his virtue. So I sent for a shroud to be bought for him, and I sent for a gravedigger to dig a grave. And we prepared bricks for him and sat heating water for him to wash him. While we were like that, the dead man suddenly jumped up, throwing the brick off his stomach, crying out for woe and destruction. When his companions saw that, some of them fled from him. So I approached him, took him by his upper arm, shook him, and said: “What did you see? And what is your condition?” He said: “I accompanied some Shaykhs from the people of Kūfah and they brought me into their religion—or he said: into their opinion or their desires—upon reviling Abū Bakr and ‘Umar (رضي الله عنهما) and freeing oneself from them.” He said: I said: “Then seek forgiveness from Allāh and do not return to it.” He said: “And how will it benefit me when I was already taken to my entrance in the Fire and shown it? Then it was said to me: You will return to your companions and narrate to them what you saw, then you will return to your former state.” I do not know if his word had even finished before he returned dead to his former state. So I waited until I was brought the shroud, took it, and then said: “I will not shroud him, nor wash him, nor pray over him.” Then I left, and I was informed that the group who were with him were the ones who took charge of washing him, burying him, and

praying over him. And they said to some people who heard what I had heard and avoided what I avoided: “What did you find objectionable about our companion? It was merely a snatching from a devil [who] spoke upon his tongue.”“ Khalaf said: “I said: ‘O Abū al-Khaṣīb, this ḥadīth that you narrated to me, was it with your own witnessing?’ He said: ‘Yes, my eyes saw it and my ears heard it.’ Khalaf said: ‘So I asked about him, and they mentioned good about him.’”

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: And ‘Alī bin Muḥammad narrated to me, from Khalaf bin Tamīm, who said: “I saw Sufyān ath-Thawrī asking this Shaykh [Abū al-Khaṣīb] about this ḥadīth.”⁹

The Juhanī

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Ibrāhīm bin ‘Abdillāh al-Harawī narrated to us, saying: Yaḥyā bin Zakariyyā bin Abī Zā'idah narrated to us, saying: Mujālid narrated to us, from ‘Āmir, who said: “We reached the courtyards of [the tribe of] Juhaynah, and there was a Shaykh sitting in one of their courtyards. I sat with him and he narrated to me, saying: ‘A man among us during the Days of Ignorance (*Jāhiliyyah*) fell ill, lost consciousness, so we covered him, thinking he had died. We ordered his grave to be dug. While we were with him, he sat up and said: “Verily, I came to where you saw me lose consciousness, and it was said to me: ‘Your mother is Hubal... Do you not see your grave being dug out? And your mother was about to be bereaved... Tell me, if we turn it away from you with a change, And we cast into it al-Qaṣl... the one who walked and gave abundantly. Will you give thanks to your Lord and pray... and abandon the path of the one who associated partners and went astray?’ I said: ‘Yes.’ So I was released. See what happened to al-Qaṣl?” They said: “He

⁹ Famous Kūfan reports compiled by the *Salaf* against the *Rāfiḍah*. Collected extensively by al-Lālikā'ī in *Sharḥ Uṣūl I'tiqād Ahl as-Sunnah* (8/1544+) and Ibn Baṭṭāh in *al-Ibānah al-Kubrā*. As well as the 4 narrations above it.

passed by just now.” So they went to look, and found that he had died. So he was buried in the grave, and the man lived until he reached Islām.”

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, Sa‘īd bin Yahyā al-Qurashī narrated to us, saying: My uncle ‘Abdullāh bin Sa‘īd narrated to us, Ziyād bin ‘Abdillāh narrated to us, saying: Mujālid narrated to us, from ash-Sha‘bī, who said: **“A Shaykh from Juhaynah narrated to me...”** then he mentioned the story, and said: **“So I saw the Juhanī after that, praying and cursing the idols and disparaging them.”**

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad bin al-Ḥusayn narrated to us, saying: from ‘Ubaydullāh bin ‘Amr ar-Raqqī, from Ismā‘īl bin Abī Khālid, from ash-Sha‘bī, who said: **“A man from Juhaynah fell ill at the beginning of Islām until his family thought he had died, and his grave was dug...”** then he mentioned the story, and added to the poetry:

‘Then we cast into it al-Qaṣl... then we filled it over him with stones; Indeed, he thought it would never be done.’

He said: And al-Ḥasan bin ‘Abd al-‘Azīz added another line for me in this poetry:

‘Will you believe in the sent Prophet?’¹⁰

‘Umar and the boy born in the grave

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad bin al-Ḥusayn narrated to me, saying: ‘Ubayd bin Ishāq narrated to me, saying: ‘Āṣim bin Muḥammad al-‘Umarī narrated to us, from Zayd bin Aslam, from his father, who said: **“While ‘Umar bin al-Khaṭṭāb was reviewing the people, a man passed by him with a son of his on his shoulder. So ‘Umar said: ‘I have not seen a crow more**

¹⁰ Collected by al-Bayhaqī in *Dalā’il an-Nubuwwah* (2/248) and Ibn ‘Asākir in *Tārīkh Dimashq*. The chains contain unknown Bedouin transmitters but were documented as early pre-Islamic historical lore.

resembling a crow than this [boy] to this [man]. ‘ So the man said: ‘As for this, by Allāh, O Commander of the Believers, his mother gave birth to him while she was dead.’ He [‘Umar] said: ‘Woe to you, how is that?’ He said: ‘I went out in such-and-such an expedition and left her pregnant, and I said: “I entrust Allāh [with] what is in your womb.” When I returned from my journey, I was informed that she had died. While I was sitting one night in al-Baqī‘ with some cousins of mine, I looked, and there was a light resembling a lamp in the graveyard. I said to my cousins: “What is this?” They said: “We do not know, except that we see this light every night at the grave of so-and-so.” So I took an axe with me, then went towards the grave, and the grave was open, and he was in the lap of his mother. I drew near, and a caller called out to me: “O you who entrusted his Lord, take your deposit. For indeed, had you entrusted his mother as well, you would have found her.” So I took the boy, and the grave closed together.’“ Abū Ja‘far said: I asked ‘Uthmān bin Zufar about this ḥadīth, and he said: “I have heard it from ‘Āṣim.”¹¹

The man who brayed like a donkey

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Ishāq bin Ismā‘īl narrated to us, saying: Sufyān bin ‘Uyaynah narrated to us, from Dāwūd bin Shābūr, from Abū Qaza‘ah, a man from the people of Baṣrah, from him or from another, who said: “We passed by some of the waters that are between us and Baṣrah, and we heard the braying of a donkey. We said to them: ‘What is this braying?’ They said: ‘This is a man who was with us; his mother used to speak to him about a matter, and he would say to her: “Bray your braying [like a donkey].” And

¹¹ Collected by al-Bayhaqī in *Dalāʾil* (6/60). The chain contains an interruption (*inqiṭāʿ*), as Zayd bin Aslam reports an event from the time of ‘Umar that he did not witness directly.

his mother would say: “May Allāh make you a donkey.” So when he died, this braying is heard at his grave every night.”¹²

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad bin Ja‘far narrated to me, saying: Manṣūr bin ‘Ammār narrated to us, saying: Abū aṣ-Ṣalt Shihāb bin Khirāsh narrated to us, from his uncle al-‘Awwām bin Ḥawshab, from Mujāhid, who said: **“I intended a matter, and while I was on the path, a donkey surprised me by extending its neck from the earth. It brayed in my face three times, then it entered. I came to the people I intended, and they said: ‘What is wrong with us that we see your color has changed [out of fear]?’ So I informed them of the news, and they said: ‘Do you not know who that is?’ I said: ‘No.’ They said: ‘That is a youth from the tribe, and that is his mother in that tent. When she used to command him with something, he would insult her and say: “You are nothing but a donkey.” Then he would bray in her face and say: “Hee-haw, hee-haw.” So he died on the day he died, and we buried him in that pit. And there is no day except that he brings out his head at the time we buried him, brays towards the tent three times, and then enters.”**

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Abū Bakr Muḥammad bin al-Mughīrah ash-Shahrūzūrī narrated to us, saying: Abū Tawbah narrated to us, saying: Shihāb bin Khirāsh narrated to us, from his uncle al-‘Awwām bin Ḥawshab, from ‘Abdullāh bin Abī al-Hudhayl, who said: **“There was a man who, if his mother spoke to him, he would bray in her face three times, then say to her: ‘You are but a donkey.’ So he died, and he would come out of his grave every day after the ‘Aṣr prayer, the head of a donkey would come out from his grave up to his chest, he would bray three times, then return to his grave.”**¹²

¹² Collected by al-Aṣbahānī in *at-Targhīb wat-Tarhīb* (2/375) and cited by al-Mundhirī (3/222) as a severe deterrent against *‘Uqūq al-Wālidayn* (disobedience to parents). As well as the 2 narrations above it.

The donkey resurrected for Nubātah bin Yazīd

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Ishāq bin Ismā‘īl, and Aḥmad bin Bujayr and others narrated to us, they said: Muḥammad bin ‘Ubayd narrated to us, from Ismā‘īl bin Abī Khālid, from ash-Sha‘bī That a group approached from Yemen as volunteers in the path of Allāh, and the donkey of a man among them died. They wanted him to set off with them, but he refused. He stood up, performed ablution, prayed, and then said: **‘O Allāh, verily I have come from ad-Dathīnah striving in Your path and seeking Your pleasure. And verily I bear witness that You give life to the dead and resurrect those in the graves. So do not place a favor [or obligation] for anyone over me, and verily I ask You to resurrect my donkey for me.’** Then he stood up to the donkey and struck it. The donkey stood up shaking its ears. He saddled it, bridled it, then rode it and made it run, catching up with his companions. They said: **‘What is your story?’** He said: **‘My story is that Allāh resurrected my donkey for me.’**“ Ash-Sha‘bī said: **“And I saw the donkey sold, or being sold, in al-Kunāsah.”**

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, al-Ḥasan bin ‘Arafah narrated to us, ‘Abdullāh bin Idrīs narrated to us, from Ismā‘īl bin Abī Khālid, from Abū Sabrah an-Nakha‘ī, [a narration] similar to it.

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: al-‘Abbās bin Hishām informed me, from his father, from his grandfather, from Muslim bin ‘Abdillāh bin Sharīk an-Nakha‘ī that the owner of the donkey was a man from an-Nakha‘ named Nubātah bin Yazīd. He went out in the time of ‘Umar (رضي الله عنه) as a warrior, until he was at Shann ‘Amīrah, his donkey died... Then he mentioned the story, except that he said: **“So he sold it afterwards in al-Kunāsah, and it was said to him: ‘You are selling a donkey that Allāh gave life to for you?’** He said: **‘So what should I do?’** Then a man from his clan spoke three lines of poetry, and I memorized this line:

“And from us is the one whose donkey the Deity brought to life... While every limb and joint of it had died.”¹³

The dead companion aiding the fighter

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Abū Sulaymān Dāwūd bin Sulaymān al-Jurjānī, the freed slave of Quraysh, narrated to me, saying: Ḥammād bin ‘Amr narrated to us, from Yazīd bin Sa‘īd al-Qurashī, from Abū ‘Abdillāh ash-Shāmī, who said: **“We fought the Romans and set up camp. Some of our men went out seeking the track of the enemy, and two men separated from them. They said: While we were like that, a Shaykh from the Romans met us, driving a donkey of his that had a packsaddle, a saddle blanket, and a saddlebag. When he looked at us, he drew his sword, shook it, then struck his donkey, slicing through the saddlebag, the packsaddle, the saddle blanket, and the donkey, until it reached the earth. Then he looked at us [and said]: ‘Have you seen what I did?’ We said: ‘Yes.’ He said: ‘Then step forward.’ So we attacked him, and we fought for an hour. One of our men was killed. Then he said to the remaining one of us: ‘Here, you have seen what your companion met?’ He said: ‘Yes.’ So he retreated, intending to return to his companions. He said: While I was returning, I said to myself: ‘May my mother be bereaved of me! My companion preceded me to Paradise, and I am returning fleeing to my companions?’ So I returned to him. I dismounted from my horse, took my shield and my sword, walked to him, and struck him, but I missed him. And he struck me, but he missed me. I threw down my weapon and embraced him [in a grapple]. He lifted me and struck the ground with me, and sat on my chest. He began reaching for something with him to kill me. Then my murdered companion came, grabbed him by the hair on the back of his neck, threw him off me, and helped me kill him. We killed him together,**

¹³ Collected by al-Bayhaqī in *Dalā’il* (6/62). As well as the 2 narrations above it.

then took his spoils. My companion began walking and talking to me until he reached a tree, then he lay down dead as he was. I came to my companions and informed them. They all came until they looked at him in that place.’¹⁴

Ibn ‘Umar witnessing the punishment of the grave

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: ‘Abd al-Raḥmān ibn Ṣāliḥ al-‘Atakī narrated to us, saying: Khālīd ibn Ḥayyān Abū Yazīd al-Raqqī narrated to us, from Kulthūm ibn Jawshan al-Qushayrī, from Yaḥyā al-Madanī, from Sālim ibn ‘Abdillāh, from his father (‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Umar رضي الله عنه), who said: “On one occasion I set out on a journey, and I passed by one of the graves from the graves of the Days of Jāhiliyyah. Suddenly, there emerged from the grave a man engulfed in blazing fire, with a chain of fire around his neck. I was carrying a small water-skin containing water. When he saw me, he said, ‘O ‘Abdullāh! Give me to drink.’ I thought, ‘He has recognised me and called me by my name,’ or perhaps it was merely an expression customarily used by the Arabs: ‘O ‘Abdullāh.’ Then there came forth behind him another man from the grave, who said, ‘O ‘Abdullāh! Do not give him to drink, for indeed he is a disbeliever (kāfir).’ He then seized the chain, pulled him back, and returned him into the grave. Thereafter, nightfall led me to seek lodging at the house of an elderly woman. Beside her house was a grave. I heard a voice coming from the grave saying: ‘Urine! And what is urine? A [worn out] waterskin! And what is a [worn out] waterskin?’ So I said to the old woman, ‘What is this?’ She replied, ‘This was once my husband. Whenever he urinated, he would not protect himself from the splashes of urine. I used to say to him, “Woe to you! Even the camel, when it urinates, spreads its legs apart to avoid being soiled (i.e the urine splashing on it).” Yet he refused. Thus, ever

¹⁴ Collected by Ibn ‘Asākir in *Tārīkh Dimashq* and Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā in *Mujābū ad-Da‘wah*.

since the day he died, he has been crying out: “Urine! And what is urine?” I then asked, “And what is the [worn out] waterskin (al-shann)?” She said, “A thirsty man once came to him and said, ‘Give me something to drink.’ So he replied, ‘There is the water-skin before you.’ But it contained nothing at all. The man then collapsed and died. So ever since the day he died, he has been crying out: ‘A [worn out] water-skin! And what is a [worn out] water-skin?’”¹⁵ When I came to the Messenger of Allāh ﷺ, I informed him of what had occurred. Thereupon, he prohibited a man from travelling alone.

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥasan bin ‘Abd al-‘Azīz al-Jarawī narrated to us, from Ḍamrah, from Ibn Shawdhab, from Abū Yaḥyā ‘Amr bin Dīnār, a freed slave of the family of az-Zubayr, from Sālim bin ‘Abdillāh bin ‘Umar, from his father, who said: “I went out as a pilgrim [for Ḥajj] or performing ‘Umrah, until I was at ar-Ruwaythah [a place] and my baggage had gone ahead. I came to the water, watered my riding beast, and filled my water-skin. The people of the water heard of me, so they gathered around me asking me questions. A man among them said: ‘Leave the man be, for his baggage has gone ahead.’ So they left me. I passed by graves facing the Qiblah, and a man emerged from them towards me with a chain around his neck blazing with fire, and the chain was in the hand of a figure. When the riding beast saw him, it bolted and he began calling out: ‘O ‘Abdullāh, pour water on me!’ And the figure was saying: ‘O ‘Abdullāh, do not pour on him.’ I do not know if he knew my name, or if it was like the saying of men to men: ‘O servant of Allāh.’ I turned, and he had swooped down upon him and struck him.”¹⁵

¹⁵ Collected by Imām Aḥmad in his *Musnad* (no. 6116, Shakir/Arna'ut numbering) and al-Bayhaqī in *Ithbāt ‘Adhāb al-Qabr* (no. 85). Shaykh al-Albānī evaluated the chain and graded it Ḥasan (good) in his checking of Ibn Abī ‘Āṣim's *as-Sunnah* (no. 874). And the narration above it.

The Judge of Banī Isrāʾīl

ʿAbdullāh narrated to us, saying: Abū Ḥātim ar-Rāzī narrated to us, saying: Ibn ʿUfayr narrated to us, saying: Yaḥyā bin Ayyūb narrated to us, from Sulaymān bin Bilāl, who said: I heard ʿAṭāʾ al-Khurāsānī saying: **“A man from the Children of Israel was appointed as a judge for forty years. When death approached him, he said: ‘I see that I will perish in this illness of mine. If I perish, keep me with you for four days, or five days. If anything about me makes you suspicious, let a man among you call out to me.’ When he passed away, he was placed in a coffin. When three days passed, his smell bothered them. So a man among them called out to him: ‘O so-and-so, what is this smell?’ So he was permitted, and he spoke, saying: ‘I was given the judgment among you for forty years, and nothing made me suspicious except two men who came to me, and I had an inclination towards one of them. I used to listen to him with the ear closest to him more than I listened with the other. So this smell is from that.’ And Allāh struck upon his ear, and he died.”**¹⁶

The affair of ʿAbbād in year 66

ʿAbdullāh narrated to us, saying: Zakariyyā ibn Yaḥyā narrated to me, saying: Kathīr ibn Yaḥyā ibn Kathīr narrated to us, saying: A shaykh from Balʿam, known as Maʿmar al-ʿAmmī, narrated to us, saying: **“We were with one of our sick companions during the year 66 (A.H.). He was a man named ʿAbbād. We thought that he had died. Some of us said, ‘He has died,’ whilst others said, ‘His soul has merely been taken up.’ Then he gestured with his hand in front of him, spreading it out, and said, ‘Where is my father? I have lost sight of you both altogether.’ Thereafter, he opened his eyes. We said to him, ‘We**

¹⁶ Collected by Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā in *Al-Ahwāl*. It is from the *Isrāʾīliyyāt*.

thought that you had died.’ He replied, ‘Indeed, I saw the angels circling above the heads of the people at the House (the Ka‘bah). One of the angels said: “O Allāh! Forgive Your servants—the dishevelled and dust-covered ones (al-shu‘th al-ghubr)¹⁷ who have come from every distant mountain pass¹⁸.” Another angel answered him, saying: “They have indeed been forgiven.” Then one of the angels said: “O people of Makkah! Were it not for those people who come to you, I would set ablaze with fire all that lies between these two mountains.” Then he said, ‘Sit me up.’ So they sat him up. He then said, ‘Young man, go and bring them some fruit.’ We replied, ‘We have no need of fruit.’ Some of us then said to one another, ‘If he has truly seen the angels as he claims, he will not remain alive.’ His fingernails immediately became green. Thereafter, we laid him back down, and he died.”¹⁹

Dāwūd bin Abī Hind’s vision

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: al-Ḥusayn bin ‘Alī al-‘Ijlī narrated to me, saying: ‘Amr bin Khālīd al-Asadī narrated to us, saying: Dāwūd bin Abī Hind narrated to us, saying: “I fell severely ill until I thought it was death. The door of my room was opposite the door of my courtyard, and the door of my courtyard was opposite the door of my house. I saw a man who had approached [me], massive in the head, massive in the shoulders, as if he were from those who are called the Zuṭṭ [a large, robust people] He said: When I saw him, I likened him to those who work with syrup [i.e., workers covered in dark soot or molasses]. I said ‘*Innā lillāhi wa innā ilayhi rāji‘ūn*’ [(I

¹⁷ الشُّعْثُ الغُبْرُ refers to the pilgrims whose hair has become dishevelled and whose bodies and garments are covered with dust due to the hardships of travel and the rites of Ḥajj. This description occurs in authentic narrations regarding the virtue of the pilgrims.

¹⁸ من كل فجٍ عميق ("from every distant mountain pass") echoes the wording of the Qur’ān in Sūrah al-Ḥajj (22:27).

¹⁹ Collected by Ibn Sa‘d in *Aṭ-Ṭabaqāt al-Kubrā*.

sought refuge)], and I said [to myself]: ‘He is going to take my soul while I am a disbeliever.’ And I had heard that a black angel takes the souls of the disbelievers. While I was like that, I heard the roof of the house breaking apart, then it split open until I saw the sky. Then a man wearing white garments descended upon me, then another followed him, so they became two. They shouted at the black one, so he turned back and began looking at me from afar. And they were driving him away. And my heart was harder than stones. One sat at my head, and one sat at my feet. He The companion at the head said to the companion at the feet: ‘Touch.’ So he touched between my toes, then said to him: ‘He frequently moved them to the prayers.’ Then the companion at the feet said to the companion at the head: ‘Touch.’ So he touched my uvula [the back of my throat], then said: ‘It is moist with the remembrance of Allāh.’ Then one of them said to his companion: ‘It is not yet time for him.’ Then the roof split open and they left, then the roof returned as it was.’²⁰

Ziyād in Sicily

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Abū ‘Alī al-Marwazī Ḥamzah bin al-‘Abbās narrated to us, ‘Alī bin al-Ḥasan and ‘Abdullāh bin ‘Uthmān informed us, both saying: ‘Abdullāh bin al-Mubārak informed us, from ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān bin Razīn al-Miṣrī, who said: ‘Abd al-Karīm bin al-Ḥārith al-Ḥaḍramī narrated to me, saying: Abū Idrīs al-Madīnī narrated to me, saying: “A man from the people of Madīnah named Ziyād came to us, and we fought in Sicily from the land of the Romans He said: We besieged a city, and we were three companions: myself, Ziyād, and another man from the people of Madīnah. While we were besieging it one day, and we had sent one of us to bring us food, a catapult rock came and landed near Ziyād. A fragment from it flew and struck

²⁰ Collected by Abū Nu‘aym in *Ḥilyat al-Awliyā’* (3/93).

Ziyād's knee, and he lost consciousness. I dragged him away, and my companion approached, so I called him and he came to me. We moved him to where neither arrows nor the catapult could reach him. We remained for a long time from the beginning of our day; nothing from him was moving. Then he broke into a smile until his molars showed, then he was still. Then he wept until his tears flowed, then he was still. Then he laughed again, then he wept again, then he was still for an hour. Then he awoke, sat up straight, and said: 'What am I doing here?' We said to him: 'Do you not know what your condition is?' He said: 'No.' We said: 'Do you not remember the catapult rock that fell next to you?' He said: 'Yes.' We said: 'Something from it struck you, and you lost consciousness, and we saw you do such-and-such.' He said: 'Yes. I inform you that I was taken to a room of ruby or chrysolite. I was taken to beds woven together, one to another. Before that were two rows of cushions. When I sat straight upon the beds, I heard the ringing of jewelry on my right [side]. Then there emerged a woman. I could not tell whether she herself was more beautiful, or her garments, or her jewellery. I went to the edge of the row. When she faced me, she welcomed me and greeted me, saying: "Welcome to the one who kept himself distant, who would not ask Allāh for us, and we are not like so-and-so's wife." When I reminded her of what I reminded her of, I laughed. She approached until she sat on my right. I said: "Who are you?" She said: "I am a maiden, your wife." When I extended my hand, she said: "Take it easy [and wait]; you will come to us at [the time of] Dhuhr." So I wept when she finished her speech. Then I heard a ringing on my left, and there I was with a woman just like her—so he described similar to that—and she did as her companion had done. So I laughed when I remembered the woman, and she sat on my left. I extended my hand, and she said: "Take it easy [and wait]; you will come to us at [the time of] Dhuhr." So I wept.' And he was sitting with us talking to us, and when the caller to prayer called the [Dhuhr] Adhān, he slumped

and died.” ‘Abd al-Karīm said: “A man used to narrate it to us from Abū Idrīs al-Madīnī. Then he came, so the man said to me: ‘Would you like to hear it from Abū Idrīs yourself?’ So I went to him and heard it from him.”²¹

The youth killed by the Roman king

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Abū Ja‘far Aḥmad bin Walīd narrated to me, saying: Aḥmad bin Abī Dāwūd narrated to me in Ṭarsūs, saying: Abū Ya‘qūb al-Ḥunaynī narrated to us, from ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān bin Zayd bin Aslam, who said: “In the past, there were youths who would go out to the land of the Romans and fight them. Captivity was decreed for them, so they were all taken. They were brought to their king, and he presented his religion to them, that they should enter into it. They said: ‘No, we would not do that, and we associate nothing with Allāh.’ So he said to his companions: ‘Deal with them.’ Their (The Romans) king sat on a hill next to a river. He called them (The Muslims), and he struck the neck of a man among them (i.e. decapitated him), so he fell into the river. Suddenly, his head stood up facing them, turning its face towards them, and saying:

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّفْسُ الْمُطْمَئِنَّةُ ۖ ارْجِعِي إِلَىٰ رَبِّكِ رَاضِيَةً مَّرْضِيَّةً ۖ فَادْخُلِي فِي عِبَادِي ۖ وَأَدْخُلِي جَنَّتِي

‘{(The Angels will say to the pious when taking their souls at death): “O you, the soul (that was) convinced, reassured and satisfied (with servitude to Allāh and His promise of reward). ۞ Return to your Lord (while you are) well-pleased (with Him and His reward), and well-pleasing (are you to Him). ۞ Then (on the Day of Judgement, it will be said:) Enter among My (honoured) servants. ۞ And enter my Paradise.”} [89:27-30]

²¹ Collected by Ibn ‘Asākir in *Tārīkh Dimashq*.

So they became terrified and stood up.”²²

‘Abd al-Wāḥid bin Zayd and the maidens of Jannah

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad bin al-Ḥusayn narrated to me, ‘Abd aṣ-Ṣamad bin ‘Abd al-Wārith narrated to us, saying: I heard ‘Abd al-Wāḥid bin Zayd, saying: **“We were in a military expedition of ours, and the enemy met us. When we dispersed, we lost a man from our companions. We searched for him and found him in a thicket²³, killed, and around him were maidens [from Paradise] beating tambourines over his head. When they saw us, they dispersed into the thicket, and we did not see them again.”**²⁴

The grave of Ḥamzah returning the greeting

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Ibrāhīm bin Sa‘īd narrated to me, saying: al-Ḥakam bin Nāfi‘ narrated to me, saying: al-‘Aṭṭāf bin Khālīd narrated to us, saying: My maternal aunt narrated to me, saying: **“I rode one day to the graves of the martyrs—and she used to constantly visit them—she said: I dismounted at the grave of Ḥamzah, and I prayed whatever Allāh willed for me to pray, and there was no caller or answerer in the valley, nothing moving except a boy standing holding the head of my animal. When I finished my prayer, I gestured like this with my hand: ‘As-Salāmu ‘Alaykum.’ I heard the return of the greeting upon me coming from under the earth; I recognized it just as I recognize that Allāh created me, and just as I recognize the night from the day. So every hair on my body stood on end [shivered].”**²⁵

²² Collected by Abū Nu‘aym in *Ḥilyat al-Awliyā’* and Ibn al-Jawzī in *Ṣifāt aṣ-Ṣafwāh*.

²³ A thicket is a very dense stand of trees or tall shrubs.

²⁴ Collected by Abū Nu‘aym in *Ḥilyat al-Awliyā’* (6/160).

²⁵ Collected by al-Bayhaqī in *Dalā’il an-Nubuwwah* (6/64).

Hearing the answers to Munkar and Nakīr

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Yaḥyā bin Ja‘far narrated to me, saying: ‘Amr bin ‘Uthmān, the nephew of ‘Alī bin ‘Āṣim, informed me: Muḥammad bin Yazīd narrated to us, from Ismā‘īl bin Abī Khālid, from Yazīd bin Ṭarīf, who said: **“My brother died. When he was buried and the people departed, I placed my head on his grave, and I heard a weak voice—I recognized it to be the voice of my brother—saying: ‘Allāh.’ Then the other said to him: ‘And what is your religion?’ He said: ‘Islām.’”**

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad bin al-Ḥusayn narrated to me, saying: Abū Zayd Shujā‘ bin al-Walīd as-Sakūnī narrated to me, saying: al-‘Alā’ bin ‘Abd al-Karīm informed me, saying: **“A man died, and he had a brother with weak eyesight. His brother said: We buried him. When the people departed, I placed my head on the grave, and suddenly there was a voice from inside the grave saying: ‘Who is your Lord? And who is your Prophet?’ So I heard the voice of my brother, and I recognized it and recognized its description. He said: ‘Allāh is my Lord, and Muḥammad is my Prophet.’ Then something resembling an arrow rose from inside the grave to my ear, so my skin stood on end (i.e it trembled), and I departed.”**²⁶

The boiling blood of Yaḥyā bin Zakariyyā

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Ishāq bin Ismā‘īl narrated to me, saying: Abū Mu‘āwiyah narrated to us, from al-A‘mash—I think from al-Minhāl bin ‘Amr—

²⁶ Collected by Ibn Abī Shaybah in *Al-Muṣannaf* (3/56) and Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā in *Al-Qubūr*. And the narration above it.

from Saʿīd bin Jubayr, from Ibn ʿAbbās, who said: “‘Īsā the son of Maryam, and Yaḥyā bin Zakariyyā [Peace be upon them both] were sent among twelve of the Hawāriyyīn [Disciples] to teach the people. Among what they taught them was forbidding them from marrying the daughter of a sister. Their king had a niece who amazed him, and he wanted to marry her, and she had a need every day that he would fulfill. When it reached her mother that they had forbidden the marriage of a niece, she said to her: ‘If you enter upon the king and he says: “Do you have a need?” then say to him: “My need is that you slaughter Yaḥyā bin Zakariyyā.”’” When she entered upon him and he asked her about her need, she said: ‘My need is that you slaughter Yaḥyā bin Zakariyyā.’ He said: ‘Ask me for other than this.’ She said: ‘I ask you for nothing but this.’ When she refused him, he called for a basin, called for him, and slaughtered him. A drop of his blood fell on the earth, and it never ceased boiling until Allāh sent Bukhtunaṣṣar (Nebuchadnezzar) against them. Allāh placed in his heart to kill them over that blood until it settled, so he killed seventy thousand of them over it.”²⁷

ʿAbdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad ibn Naṣr ibn al-Walīd narrated to me, from Abū Saʿīd al-Shaqarī, from Abū Bakr al-Hudhalī, from Shahr ibn Ḥawshab, who said: “When he had been killed, his head was handed over to her. She placed it in a basin made of gold and sent it as a gift to her mother. Then the head began to speak while it was in the basin, saying: ‘Indeed, she is not lawful for him, nor is he lawful for her.’ It repeated this three times. When her mother saw the head, she said: ‘Today my eyes have been cooled, and my kingdom is secure.’ She then clothed herself in a coat of silk, a silk head-covering, and a silk outer garment. Thereafter she ascended to one of

²⁷ Collected by Ibn Abī Shaybah in *al-Muṣannaf* (11/498) and Imām Aḥmad in *az-Zuhd* (no. 367). It is an authentic transmission from Ibn ʿAbbās reporting from the lore of Banī Isrāʾīl and the same goes for the narration under it, though it is most likely originally derived from *isrāʾīliyyāt* and the prophet ordered us to neither affirm them nor deny them.

her palaces. She kept dogs which were fed upon the flesh of people. As she was walking upon her palace, Allāh sent against her a violent wind. It wrapped her up in her garments and cast her down among her dogs. They began tearing at her flesh while she looked on. The last part of her that they consumed was her eyes.”

Muṭarrif bin ‘Abdillāh and Sūrah as-Sajdah

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad bin al-Ḥusayn narrated to me, saying: ‘Īsā bin Sālim narrated to me, saying: Abū al-Malīḥ ar-Raqqī narrated to us, from al-Ḥasan bin Dīnār, who said: Thābit al-Bunānī and another man narrated to me that they entered upon Muṭarrif bin ‘Abdillāh bin ash-Shikḥkhīr to visit him [while he was sick], and they found him unconscious. He said: **Three lights emanated from him: the first from his head, the middle from his waist, and the last from his feet. That terrified us. When he awoke, we said to him: ‘How are you, O Abū ‘Abdillāh? We saw something that terrified us.’ He said: ‘And what is it?’ So we informed him. He said: ‘And you saw that?’ We said: ‘Yes.’ He said: ‘That was Tanzīl as-Sajdah [Sūrah as-Sajdah], and it is twenty-nine verses. The first of it emanated from my head, its middle from my waist, and its end from my feet. It has ascended to intercede for me. And this is Tabārah [Sūrah al-Mulk] guarding me.’ Then he died, may Allāh have mercy upon him.**”

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Abū al-Ḥasan Aḥmad bin ‘Abd al-A‘lā ash-Shaybānī narrated to us, saying: ‘Īṣām bin Ṭalīq narrated to us, from a Shaykh from the people of Baṣrah, from Muwarriq al-‘Ijlī, who said: **“We visited a man who had lost consciousness. A light emerged from his head until it reached the ceiling, pierced it, and passed. Then it emerged from his navel until it did the same. Then a light emerged from his feet until it did the same. Then he awoke, and we said to him: ‘Did you know what happened from you?’ He**

said: ‘Yes. As for the light that emerged from my head: it was fourteen verses from the beginning of *Alif-Lām-Mīm Tanzīl as-Sajdah*. As for the light that emerged from my navel, it was the verse of prostration (*Sajdah*). And as for the light that emerged from my feet, it was the end of *Sūrah as-Sajdah*. They went to intercede for me, and *Tabārak* remained with me guarding me. And I used to recite them both every night.’²⁸

Cain suspended at the pool

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Abū Ya‘qūb at-Tamīmī Yūsuf bin Ya‘qūb narrated to me, saying: The nephew of ‘Abdullāh bin Wahb and Ibn Abī Nājiyah narrated to us, both saying: Ziyād bin Yūnus al-Ḥaḍramī narrated to us, from ‘Abd al-Malik bin Qudāmah, from ‘Abdullāh bin Dīnār, from Abū Ayyūb al-Yamānī, from a man from his people called ‘Abdullāh That he and a group of his people traveled by sea, and the sea grew dark upon them for days. Then that darkness cleared from them while they were near a village. ‘Abdullāh said: “I went out seeking water, and the doors were locked with the wind howling through them. I called out into them, but no one answered me. While I was like that, two horsemen appeared to me, under each of them was a white blanket. They asked me about my affair, so I informed them of what had befallen us in the sea and that I had come out seeking water. They said to me: ‘O servant of Allāh, travel down this path, for it will lead you to a pool containing water, so drink from it, and do not let what you see in it terrify you.’ So I asked them about those locked houses where the wind was howling. They said: ‘These are houses containing the souls of the dead.’ So I went until I reached the pool. In it was a suspended man, pointing his head towards me, wanting to reach the water with his hand, but he could not reach it. When he saw me, he called out to me and said: ‘O servant of Allāh,

²⁸ Collected by Abū Nu‘aym in *Ḥilyat al-Awliyā’* (2/204).

give me water.’ So I scooped with the cup to hand it to him, but my hand was seized. So he said to me: ‘Wet the turban, then throw it to me.’ So I wet the turban to throw it to him, but my hand was seized. So I said: ‘O servant of Allāh, you have seen what I did. I scooped with the cup to hand it to you, and my hand was seized. And I wet the turban to throw it to you, and my hand was seized. So tell me, who are you?’ He said: ‘I am the son of Ādam; I am the first who shed blood on the earth (Cain).’²⁹

The Pharaoh’s family

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Ḥammād bin Muḥammad al-Fazārī narrated to us, saying: It reached me from al-Awzā‘ī, that a man asked him in ‘Asqalān on the coast, and it was said to him: “O Abū ‘Amr, we see black birds emerging from the sea, and when the evening comes, the likes of them return white.” He said: “And you noticed that?” They said: “Yes.” He said: “Those are birds in whose crops [throats or stomachs] are the souls of the family of Pharaoh. They are exposed to the Fire, so it scorches them and their feathers turn black. Then those feathers are shed, then they return to their nests, and the Fire scorches them. That is their perpetual state until the Hour is established.” Then it is said:

أَدْخِلُوا آلَ فِرْعَوْنَ أَشَدَّ الْعَذَابِ

{Admit the family of Pharaoh into the severest punishment.} [40:46].

The Imprisoned Father in Antioch

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad ibn al-Ḥusayn narrated to us, saying: Shu‘ayb ibn Muḥriz al-Azdī narrated to me, saying: Shaybān ibn al-

²⁹ Collected by Imām Aḥmad in *Az-Zuhd* and Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā in *Al-Uqūbāt*.

Ḥasan narrated to us, saying: “My father and ‘Abd al-Wāḥid ibn Zayd set out intending to participate in a military expedition. Along the way they came upon a broad, deep well. They lowered a bucket into it by means of their ropes, but the bucket fell into the well. They then tied their own ropes together with those of their companions until they had a sufficient length, and one of the two men descended into the well. When he had descended partway, he heard voices murmuring from within it. He immediately climbed back up and said to his companion, ‘Do you hear what I hear?’ He replied, ‘Yes.’ The first man then said, ‘Hand me the pole.’ After taking hold of the pole, he descended into the well once more. As he went farther down, the murmuring and voices became ever clearer. He eventually came upon a man seated upon wooden planks, with water beneath him. He asked him, ‘Are you a jinn or a human being?’ The man replied, ‘Rather, I am a human being.’ He asked, ‘Who are you?’ The man replied, ‘I am a man from the people of Anṭākiyah (Antioch). I died, but my Lord has detained me here because of a debt that I owed. My children, who remain in Antioch, have forgotten me and have not settled it on my behalf.’ The man then climbed out of the well and said to his companion, ‘An expedition after an expedition! Let our companions go.’ So the two of them hired a mount and travelled to Antioch. They asked about the man and his sons, and the people said, ‘Yes, by Allāh, he is indeed our father. We have recently sold one of our properties. Come with us so that we may pay off his debt.’ They accompanied them until the debt had been settled. Thereafter they returned from Antioch to the place where they had found the well, fully expecting to find it there. However, there was neither any well nor any trace of it. They spent that night there, and the man appeared to them in a dream, saying, ‘May Allāh reward you both with goodness. Indeed, ever

since my debt was settled on my behalf, my Lord has transferred me to such-and-such a place in Paradise.’³⁰

Qur’ānic Tafsīr Reports

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, Muḥammad bin Yūnus al-Qurashī mentioned, Abū Bakr al-Ḥanafī narrated to us, ‘Umar bin Sulaym al-Madanī narrated to us, saying: I heard Muḥammad bin Ka‘b al-Quraḏī regarding the statement of Allāh the Exalted:

وَأَخْتَارَ مُوسَىٰ قَوْمَهُ سَبْعِينَ رَجُلًا

{And Mūsā chose from his people seventy men.} [70:155]

“He chose from their righteous ones seventy men, then went out with them. They said: ‘Where are you taking us?’ He said: ‘I am taking you to my Lord, He promised me to reveal the Torah to me.’ They said: ‘We will not believe in it until we look at Him.’ So the thunderbolt seized them while they were looking, and Mūsā remained standing among them with no one from them with him [remaining alive]. He said:

رَبِّ لَوْ شِئْتَ أَهْلَكْتَهُمْ مِنْ قَبْلِ وَإِيَّايَ أَهْلَكُنَا بِمَا فَعَلَ السُّفَهَاءُ مِنَّا

{“My Lord, if You had willed, You could have destroyed them before and me [as well]. Would You destroy us for what the foolish among us have done?”} [70:155].

[And he said:] ‘What will I say to the Children of Israel when I return to them and there is not a man with me from those who went out with me?’ Then he recited:

ثُمَّ بَعَثْنَاكُمْ مِنْ بَعْدِ مَوْتِكُمْ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَشْكُرُونَ

³⁰ Collected by Abū Nu‘aym in *Ḥilyat al-Awliyā’* (6/163).

‘{Then We revived you after your death that perhaps you would be grateful.}’ [2:56].

They then said: ‘Hudnā ilayk (“We have turned to You in repentance”).’ He said: “It was due to this that the Jews attached themselves to this expression, and thus they came to be called Yahūd (Jews) on account of this word.”

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Ishāq bin Ismā‘īl narrated to us, saying: Jarīr narrated to us, from Ḥuṣayn bin ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān, from Hilāl bin Yasāf, regarding the statement of Allāh, the Blessed and Exalted:

أَلَمْ تَرَ إِلَى الَّذِينَ خَرَجُوا مِنْ دِيَارِهِمْ وَهُمْ أُلُوفٌ حَذَرَ الْمَوْتِ

{Have you not considered those who left their homes in many thousands, fearing death?} [2:243]

“There were people from the Children of Israel; when disease struck them, their rich and nobles would leave, and their poor and lowly would remain. Death was severe upon those who remained, while nothing afflicted the others. When one of those years came, they said: ‘If we remain as they remained, we will perish as they perished.’ And these said: ‘If we travel as they traveled, we will be saved as they were saved.’ So they agreed in one year to flee. They did so, until they reached where Allāh willed them to reach, and Allāh sent death upon them until they became gleaming [white] bones. The people of the lands and the paths swept them up and gathered them in one place. A Prophet of theirs passed by them.” (Ḥuṣayn said: I think he said: “Ḥizqīl [Ezekiel]) And he said: ‘O Lord, if You willed, You could revive these so they may worship You, populate Your lands, and give birth to Your servants.’ So his lord said: ‘And would you like Me to do so?’ He said: ‘Yes.’ And It was said to him: “Say such and such.” So he spoke with a command he was ordered with. And he looked at the bones being clothed with flesh

and nerves. Then he spoke with a command he was ordered with, and suddenly they were forms [with life] declaring the greatness of Allāh, glorifying Him, and declaring His oneness. So they lived as long as Allāh willed them to live.”

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Khalaf bin Hishām and others narrated to us, they said: Ḥazm bin Abī Ḥazm narrated to us, saying: I heard al-Ḥasan regarding this verse:

أَوْ كَالَّذِي مَرَّ عَلَى قَرْيَةٍ وَهِيَ خَاوِيَةٌ عَلَى عُرُوشِهَا قَالَ أَنَّى يُحْيِي هَذِهِ اللَّهُ بَعْدَ مَوْتِهَا فَأَمَاتَهُ اللَّهُ مِائَةَ عَامٍ ثُمَّ بَعَثَهُ

{Or [consider such an example] as the one who passed by a township which had fallen into ruin. He said, “How will Allah bring this to life after its death?” So Allah caused him to die for a hundred years; then He revived him.} [2:259]

“It was mentioned to me that He caused him to die in the late morning, then revived him when the sun had declined, before it set.”

أَلَمْ يَلَيْسَ قَالَ لَيْسَ يَوْمًا أَوْ بَعْضَ يَوْمٍ قَالَ بَلْ لَيْسَ مِائَةَ عَامٍ فَانْظُرْ إِلَى طَعَامِكَ وَشَرَابِكَ لَمْ يَتَسَنَّهْ وَانْظُرْ إِلَى جِمَازِكَ وَلِنَجْعَلَكَ آيَةً لِلنَّاسِ

{He said, “How long have you remained?” The man said, “I have remained a day or part of a day.” He said, “Rather, you have remained one hundred years. Look at your food and your drink; it has not changed with time. And look at your donkey; and We will make you a sign for the people.} [2:259]

Verily, his donkey was beside him, and his food and drink had been protected from birds and beasts.

وَانْظُرْ إِلَى الْعِظَامِ كَيْفَ نُنْشِزُهَا ثُمَّ نَكْسُوهَا لَحْمًا

{And look at the bones [of this donkey] - how We raise them and then We cover them with flesh} [al-Baqarah: 259]

It was mentioned to me that the first thing created from him was his eyes. He began looking at the bones bone by bone, how they returned to their places.” When it became clear to him, he said:

أَعْلَمُ أَنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ

{I know that Allāh is over all things competent.}” [al-Baqarah: 259]

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Ishāq bin Ismā‘īl narrated to us, saying: Qabīshah narrated to us, from Sufyān, from al-A‘mash [regarding the verse]:

وَلَنَجْعَلَكَ آيَةً لِلنَّاسِ

{And We will make you a sign for the people} [2: 259]

“He came (i.e woke up) as a youth, while his children were old men.”

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Abū Khaythamah narrated to us, saying: Yaḥyā bin Sa‘īd narrated to us, from Rabī‘ah bin Kulthūm, who said: My father narrated to me, from Sa‘īd bin Jubayr, from Ibn ‘Abbās, who said: **“There were two cities in the Children of Israel, one of them was fortified and had doors, and the other was in ruins. The people of the fortified city would lock their doors when evening came, and when morning came, they would stand on the wall of the city and look to see if any event had occurred around it. One morning, there was a murdered old man thrown at the base of their city. The people of the ruined city approached and said: ‘Did you kill our companion?’ And a nephew of his, a youth, was weeping near him, saying: ‘You killed my uncle.’ They said: ‘By Allāh, we have not opened our city since we locked it, and we are not stained with the blood of this companion of yours in the slightest.’ So they came to Mūsā (Peace be upon him). Allāh (عز وجل) revealed to Mūsā (صلى الله عليه وسلم):**

وَإِذْ قَالَ مُوسَى لِقَوْمِهِ إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْمُرُكُمْ أَنْ تَذْبَحُوا بَقَرَةً قَالُوا أَنْتَ خَدُّنَا هَؤُلَاءِ قَالَ أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ أَنْ أَكُونَ مِنَ الْجَاهِلِينَ ﴿٢٥٠﴾ قَالُوا ادْعُ لَنَا رَبَّكَ يُبَيِّنْ لَنَا مَا هِيَ قَالَ إِنَّهُ يَقُولُ إِنَّهَا بَقَرَةٌ لَا فَارِضٌ وَلَا بِكْرٌ عَوَانٌ بَيْنَ ذَلِكَ فافْعَلُوا مَا تُؤْمَرُونَ

{And [recall] when Moses said to his people, “Indeed, Allah commands you to slaughter a cow.” They said, “Do you take us in ridicule?” He said, “I seek refuge in Allah from being among the ignorant.” ﴿٦٧﴾ They said, “Call upon your Lord to make clear to us what it is.” [Moses] said, “[Allah] says, ‘It is a cow which is neither old nor virgin, but median between that,’ so do what you are commanded.”} [2:67-68]

Until:

فَذَبَحُوهَا وَمَا كَادُوا يَفْعَلُونَ

So they slaughtered her, but they could hardly do it. [2:71]

And there was a young boy in the Children of Israel who sold in a shop of his, and he had a very old father. A man from another town came seeking a commodity of his, and offered him a price for it. So he went with the man to open his shop and give him what he requested, but the key was with his father, and his father was asleep in the shade of the shop. The man said: ‘Wake him up.’ He responded: ‘By Allāh, my father is sleeping as you see, and I hate to startle him from his sleep.’ So they left. They returned to the Shaykh, snoring in his sleep. The man said: ‘Wake him up.’ He responded: ‘By Allāh, I hate to startle him from his slumber.’ So they left. The offered him double what he had offered [before], so he turned back to his father, and he was sleeping deeper than before. The man said: ‘Wake him up.’ He replied: ‘No, by Allāh, I will never wake him, nor startle him from his sleep.’ So when the seeker of the commodity left and went away, the Shaykh woke up. His son said to him: ‘O father, by Allāh, a man came here seeking such-and-such a commodity, but I hated to startle you from your sleep.’ So the Shaykh blamed him. But Allāh compensated him for his dutifulness to his father, such that a cow was born from his cows, which was the very cow the Children of Israel were seeking. They came to him and said: ‘Sell it to us.’ He said: ‘I will not sell it to you.’ They said: ‘Then we will take it from you.’

He said: ‘If you usurp my commodity, you know best.’ So they came to Mūsā (Peace be upon him). He said: ‘Go and satisfy him for his commodity.’ They said: ‘What is your condition?’ He said: ‘My condition is that you place the cow in one pan of the scale, and place solid gold in the other pan. When the gold tips the scale, I will take it.’ So they did, and they brought the cow until they came to the grave of the Shaykh, which was between the two cities. The people of the two cities and his nephew gathered at his grave weeping. They slaughtered it and struck the grave with a piece of its flesh. The Shaykh stood up, shaking his head, saying: ‘My nephew killed me. My life was too long for him, and he wanted to take my wealth.’ And he died.”

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, Abū Ḥafṣ aṣ-Ṣaffār said: Ja‘far bin Sulaymān said, from ‘Amr bin Mālīk an-Nukrī, from Abū al-Jawzā’, regarding:

وَإِذْ قَالَ إِبْرَاهِيمُ رَبِّ أَرِنِي كَيْفَ تُحْيِي الْمَوْتَىٰ قَالَ أَوَلَمْ تُؤْمِنْ قَالَ بَلَىٰ وَلَٰكِن لِّيَطْمَئِنَّ قَلْبِي

“{And [mention] when Abraham said, “My Lord, show me how You give life to the dead.” [Allah] said, “Have you not believed?” He said, “Yes, but [I ask] only that my heart may be satisfied.}” [2:260]

He said: “It was said to him: ‘Take four birds and so incline them to yourself; meaning: train them until they respond to you.’ Then He commanded him to slaughter them when they responded to him. So he slaughtered them, then plucked them and cut them up. He said: So he mixed their blood together, and mixed all their feathers and their meat. He said: Then it was said to him: ‘Place a portion of them on four mountains, then call them, they will come to you in haste.’ So he did, then he called them. He said: So the blood began going to the blood, the feathers to the feathers, the meat to the meat, and everything to its place, until they responded to him.” Then he said:

أَعْلَمُ أَنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَىٰ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ

“{I know that Allāh is over all things competent.}” [2:259].³¹

Al-Ḥuwayrith and the Burning Man

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Abū Bakr al-Madīnī narrated to us, saying: Ibn ‘Ufayr narrated to us, saying: Yaḥyā bin Ayyūb narrated to me, from Ibn al-Hād, from Muḥammad bin Ibrāhīm, from al-Ḥuwayrith bin ar-Ri’āb, who said: “While I was at al-Uthāthah, a person emerged upon us from his [own] grave; his face and head were blazing with fire, and he was in a shackle of iron. He said: ‘Give me water, give me water from the water-skin.’ Another person emerged in his tracks and said: ‘Do not give the disbeliever water, do not give the disbeliever water.’ He caught up with him, grabbed the end of the chain, pulled him, and threw him down. Then he dragged him until they both entered the grave. So the she-camel bolted with me, and I had no control over it until it twisted at the root of a tree (‘Irq aḏ-Ḍabyah). It knelt, so I dismounted and prayed Maghrib and ‘Ishā’. Then I rode until morning came upon me in Madīnah. I came to ‘Umar bin al-Khaṭṭāb (رضي الله عنه) and informed him of the news. He said: ‘O Ḥuwayrith, by Allāh, I do not accuse you (i.e of lying), and you have certainly informed me of a severe news.’ Then ‘Umar sent for the Shaykhs from the regions of aṣ-Ṣafrā’ who had lived during the Jāhiliyyah. Then he called al-Ḥuwayrith and said: ‘This one has narrated a ḥadīth to me, and I do not accuse him. Narrate to them, O Ḥuwayrith, what you narrated to me.’ So I narrated to them, and they said: ‘We recognize him, O Commander of the Believers. This is a man from Banī Ghifār who died in the Jāhiliyyah.’ So ‘Umar praised Allāh and was pleased by that, as they informed that he died in the Jāhiliyyah. ‘Umar asked them

³¹ This narration and the 5 above it are documented with these exact chains by Imām aṭ-Ṭabarī in *Jāmi‘ al-Bayān* under the respective verses (al-Baqarah 243, 259, 260; al-A‘rāf 155).

about him, and they said: ‘O Commander of the Believers, he was a man from the men of the Jāhiliyyah, and he never saw any right for the guest.’³²

The Heat of Death After One Hundred Years

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Ishāq bin Ismā‘īl narrated to us, Wakī‘ and ‘Abdullāh bin Numayr narrated to us, from ar-Rabī‘ bin Sa‘d al-Ju‘fi, from ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān bin Sābiṭ, from Jābir bin ‘Abdillāh, who said: **The Prophet (صلی اللہ علیہ وسلم)** said: “Narrate from the Children of Israel, for verily, there were wonders among them.” Then he began to narrate, saying: “A group [of travelers] went out once traveling in the land, and they passed by a graveyard. Some of them said to the others: ‘If we prayed two Rak‘ahs, then supplicated to Allāh, perhaps He would bring out one of the people of this graveyard to inform us about death.’ He said: So they prayed two Rak‘ahs, then supplicated. Suddenly, a dark-skinned [or mixed heritage] man emerged from a grave shaking his head, and between his eyes was the mark of prostration. He said: ‘O people, what did you want from this? Verily, I died a hundred years ago, yet the heat of death has not subsided from me until this hour. So supplicate to Allāh to return me as I was.’”³³

‘Īsā Raising Sām bin Nūḥ

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Khalaf bin Hishām narrated to us, saying: ‘Awn bin Mūsā narrated to us, he heard Mu‘āwiyah bin Qurrah, saying: “**The Children of Israel asked ‘Īsā the son of Maryam (Peace be upon him), saying: ‘O Spirit of Allāh and His Word, verily Sām the son of Nūḥ is buried near here, so supplicate to Allāh to resurrect him for us.’ He said: So the Prophet**

³² Collected by al-Bayhaqī in *Ithbāt ‘Adhāb al-Qabr* (no. 87).

³³ The ḥadith is *ṣaḥīḥ*, collected by Imām Aḥmad in *al-Musnad* (3/344) and Abū Dāwūd (no. 3662). The subsequent story is found in Aḥmad's *az-Zuhd*.

of Allāh called out to him, but saw nothing. He called out, but saw nothing. They said: ‘He is indeed buried near here.’ So the Prophet of Allāh called out, and a gray-haired man emerged. They said: ‘O Spirit of Allāh and His Word, we were informed that he died while he was a youth, so what is this whiteness?’ So ‘Īsā (Peace be upon him) said to him: ‘What is this whiteness?’ He said: ‘I thought it was the Cry [of the Day of Judgment], so I became terrified.’³⁴

The Woman Reviving at the Grave

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Aḥmad bin ‘Adī aṭ-Ṭā’ī narrated to us, that he heard a Shaykh in Kūfah among Banī Kawr mention that he witnessed the funeral of a woman. When she was brought to the grave, she moved. He said: **“So she was returned [to life], and she lived for a long time after that and gave birth.”**

The Woman of Banī Isrā’īl and Her Sons

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Abū Kurayb narrated to us, saying: Zakariyyā bin ‘Adī narrated to us, saying: Khālīd bin Yazīd al-Hadādī narrated to us, from Thābit al-Bunānī: **That a woman from the Children of Israel was an excellent wife to her husband. Two sons of hers fell into a well and died. So she ordered that they be brought out, cleaned, washed, placed on a bed, and covered with a garment. Then she instructed her servants and the people of her house not to inform their father of anything concerning their affair until she herself spoke to him. When their father came, food was placed before him. He said: ‘Where are my sons?’ She said: ‘They have slept and rested.’ He said: ‘No, by the life of Allāh! O so-and-so, O so-and-so!’ And they**

³⁴ Collected by Imām Aḥmad in *az-Zuhd* (no. 331) and Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā in *al-Qubūr*.

answered (i.e they spoke). And Allāh had returned their souls to them as gratitude for what she had done.”³⁵

The Youth Whose Head Recited the Qur'an

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Muḥammad bin Idrīs narrated to me, saying: Sa‘īd al-‘Ammī narrated to us, saying: “A group of warriors set out by sea, and a youth who was somewhat reckless (or troublesome) came to ride with them, but they refused him. Then, they eventually carried him with them. They met the enemy, and the youth was among the best of them in fighting. Then he was killed. His head stood up (in the sea), faced the people of the ship, and he was reciting:

تِلْكَ الدَّارُ الْآخِرَةُ نَجْعُهَا لِلَّذِينَ لَا يُرِيدُونَ عُلُوًّا فِي الْأَرْضِ وَلَا فَسَادًا وَالْعَاقِبَةُ لِلْمُتَّقِينَ

{That home of the Hereafter We assign to those who do not desire exaltedness upon the earth or corruption. And the [best] outcome is for the righteous.} [al-Qaṣaṣ: 83].

Then it (i.e his head) submerged [into the water] and disappeared.”³⁶

The Head That Condemned a Murderer

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Abū Bakr ‘Abdullāh narrated to me, saying: ‘Alī bin Naṣr al-Jahḍamī mentioned, saying: Khālīd bin Yazīd al-Hadādī narrated to me, saying: Ash‘ath bin Jābir al-Ḥuddānī narrated to us, from Khulayd bin Sulaymān al-‘Aṣarī. Khālīd said: I met Khulayd and he narrated to me: That a woman narrated to him during the plague of the young women³⁷, saying: “My

³⁵ Collected by Imām Aḥmad in *az-Zuhd* (no. 352).

³⁶ Collected by Abū Nu‘aym in *Ḥilyat al-Awliyā’* (9/315).

³⁷ A historical epidemic struck the Levant and Iraq in the year (87 AH / 706-707 AD) during the reign of the Umayyad Caliph Al-Walid ibn Abd al-Malik and the governorship of Al-Hajjaj ibn Yusuf Al-Thaqafi.

husband died while he was with me in the house, and we had not yet buried him. When the night had enveloped us, we heard a terrifying voice. With me was a son of mine who was somewhat reckless, so he came and took shelter with me beneath my garment. The voice drew nearer until a severed head climbed over the wall toward us, calling out: ‘O so-and-so! *Receive glad tidings of the Fire!* You killed a believing soul without right.’ Then the severed head entered him (i.e her son) through his feet and emerged from the top of his head, all the while calling out. Then it entered (i.e her son) again through the top of his head until it emerged from beneath his feet, calling out: ‘O so-and-so! *Receive glad tidings of the Fire!*’ Then it climbed back over the wall, continuing to call out, until its voice faded away from us.”³⁸

Righteous and Wicked Deeds Personified

‘Abdullāh narrated to us, saying: Zakariyyā bin Yaḥyā narrated to us, saying: Kathīr bin Yaḥyā bin Kathīr al-Baṣrī narrated to us, saying: My father narrated to me, saying: Abū Mas‘ūd al-Jurayrī narrated to us, saying: A Shaykh narrated to me in the mosque of the Shaykhs, who used to narrate to us from Abū Hurayrah, who said: “While we were around a sick person of ours, he quieted and became still until not a vein in him was moving. So we covered him and closed his eyes. We sent for his garments, his lote-tree leaves [used for washing the dead], and his bier. When we went to carry him to wash him, he moved. We said: ‘Glory be to Allāh! Glory be to Allāh! We only thought that you had died.’ He said: ‘Verily, I had died, and I was taken to my grave. There was a person with a beautiful face and a pleasant smell who placed me in my niche [in the grave] and folded it over with scrolls. Suddenly, a black woman with a foul smell came and said: “This is the companion of such-and-such, and this is the companion of such-and-such,” things, by

³⁸ Collected by Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā in *al-Uqūbāt*.

Allāh, I am ashamed of, as if I had just ceased them at that moment.’ He said: ‘I said [(to the beautiful man)]: “I adjure you by Allāh to leave me and her.” She said: “We will dispute with you.”’ He said: ‘So we went to a vast, spacious abode. In it was a raised platform as if it were made of silver. In a corner of it was a mosque, and a man was standing in prayer. He recited Sūrah an-Naḥl, but hesitated at a place in it, so I corrected him. He turned and said: “Do you have the Sūrah?” I said: “Yes.” He said: “Verily, it is the Sūrah of Blessings (*an-Ni‘am*).”’ He said: ‘He lifted a cushion near him and brought out a scroll, looking into it. The black woman rushed and said: “He did such-and-such, and he did such-and-such.”’ He said: ‘And the beautiful-faced one began saying: “And he did such-and-such, and he did such-and-such, and he did such-and-such,” mentioning my good deeds.’ He said: ‘So the man said: “A servant who wronged himself, but Allāh (عز وجل) has pardoned him. The time of this one has not come yet; the time of this one is on Monday.”’ He said: ‘So he [(the sick man)] said to them: “Look, if I die on Monday, then attribute what I saw to me. But if I do not die on Monday, then it is merely the delirium of pain.”’ He said: ‘So when Monday came, he remained healthy until he descended [in health] after ‘Aṣr, then his time came and he died.’ And in the ḥadīth: ‘When we left the man, I said to the beautiful-faced, pleasant-smelling man: “What are you?” He said: “I am your righteous deeds.” I said: “And what is the black, foul-smelling woman?” He said: “That is your wicked deeds.”’ Or speech resembling this.”³⁹

[End of the book]

³⁹ A famous *Mawqūf* report. Collected by ‘Abdullāh Ibn al-Mubārak in *az-Zuhd* (no. 1243) and Ibn Abī Shaybah in *al-Muṣannaf* (7/159).

Translator's Introduction

All praise is due to Allāh, the Creator of the heavens and the earth, the One who overcomes His creation with death. May the most complete peace and blessings be upon the Messenger of Allāh, who stood at the edge of graves and wept until the soil was wet, and upon his family, his Companions, and all who follow their path until the appointed Hour.

To proceed:

I do not usually add an outro to the books I translate. I generally prefer to let the words of the early scholars stand entirely on their own. However, I felt a strong need to write a conclusion for this specific book. Imām Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā's collection has almost no commentary; it is a quick, continuous series of raw narrations. Because the text does not pause to explain things along the way, I felt it needed a few final words. This gives the reader a chance to pause, breathe, and process the heavy weight of what they have just read.

As we finish this translation of *Man 'Āsha Ba'da al-Mawt*, the soul is left standing before a frightening mirror. The physical world that takes up all our time—our wealth, our arguments, and our ambitions—suddenly feels very empty. The stories we have just read are not just interesting historical tales. They violently tear down the veil that separates the world of the living from the world of the *Barzakh*.

Mankind lives in a state of deep distraction, fooled by the false hope of a long life and a lasting world. Yet, Allāh (عز وجل) shatters this illusion in His Book, declaring:

وَجَاءَتْ سَكْرَةُ الْمَوْتِ بِالْحَقِّ ذَلِكَ مَا كُنْتَ مِنْهُ تَحِيدُ

{And the stupor of death will come in truth: “This is what you have been avoiding!”} [50:19]

Through the reports of the Salaf, we have heard the echoes of that undeniable truth. We read about the man who brayed like a donkey as a punishment for his disobedience, the blackened faces of those who cursed the Companions, and the blazing chains dragged into the graves. These are the screams of the dead who have finally seen the reality of their actions, begging for a second chance that will never come. How perfectly do these historical accounts match the Divine Warning:

حَتَّىٰ إِذَا جَاءَ أَحَدَهُمُ الْمَوْتُ قَالَ رَبِّ ارْجِعُونِ ﴿١٩﴾ لَعَلِّي أَعْمَلُ صَالِحًا فِيمَا تَرَكْتُ كَلَّا إِنَّهَا كَلِمَةٌ هُوَ قَائِلُهَا وَمِنْ وَرَائِهِمْ بَرْزَخٌ إِلَىٰ يَوْمِ يُبْعَثُونَ

{Until, when death comes to one of them, he says: “My Lord! Send me back, So that I may do good in that which I have left behind!” No! It is but a word that he speaks, and behind them is Barzakh (a barrier) until the Day when they will be resurrected.} [23:99-100]

However, this book is not just a collection of terrifying stories; it is also a beautiful proof of Allāh’s mercy upon the believers. We saw the youth greeted by angels, the martyrs resting in Paradise, and righteous good deeds taking the form of a beautiful, sweet-smelling companion in the lonely grave. It reinforces the true standard of success set by our Creator:

كُلُّ نَفْسٍ ذَائِقَةُ الْمَوْتِ وَإِنَّمَا تُوَفَّوْنَ أُجُورَكُمْ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ ۚ فَمَنْ زُحْزِحَ عَنِ النَّارِ وَأُدْخِلَ الْجَنَّةَ فَقَدْ فَازَ وَمَا الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا إِلَّا مَتَاعُ الْغُرُورِ

{Everyone shall taste death. And only on the Day of Resurrection shall you be paid your wages in full. And whoever is removed away from the Fire and admitted to Paradise, he indeed is successful. The life of this world is only the enjoyment of deception (a deceiving thing).} [3:185]

The goal of translating this specific book into English is to revive the spiritual awareness of the early generations within ourselves. We must realize that the shroud we will wear is already woven, and the earth we walk upon is patiently waiting to take us in.

I ask Allāh, the Exalted, to reward the Imām, Abū Bakr Ibn Abī ad-Dunyā, with the highest levels of Paradise for gathering these warnings. I ask Him to overlook my mistakes and shortcomings in this translation if there are any. May He make this book a heavy weight of good deeds for everyone who reads it, reflects on it, and changes their life because of it.

May Allāh grant us *Ḥusn al-Khātimah* (a good end), protect us from the trials of the grave, and resurrect us safely under the banner of our beloved Prophet (صلى الله عليه وسلم).

Wal-Ḥamdu lillāhi Rabbil-‘Ālamīn.